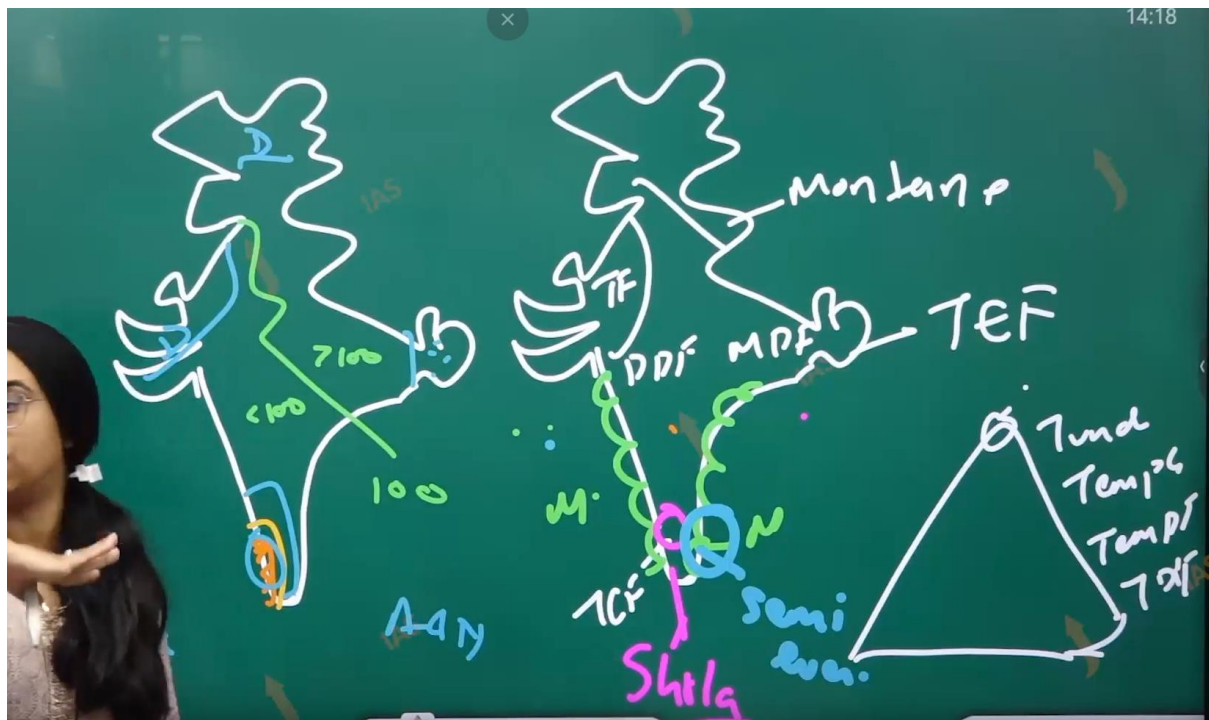


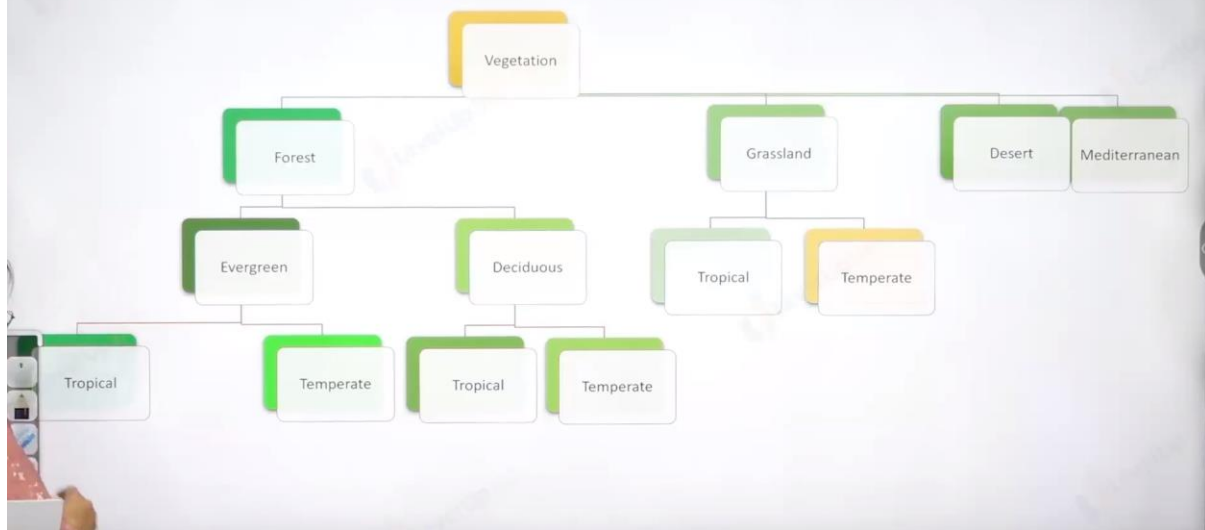
(34) Vegetation

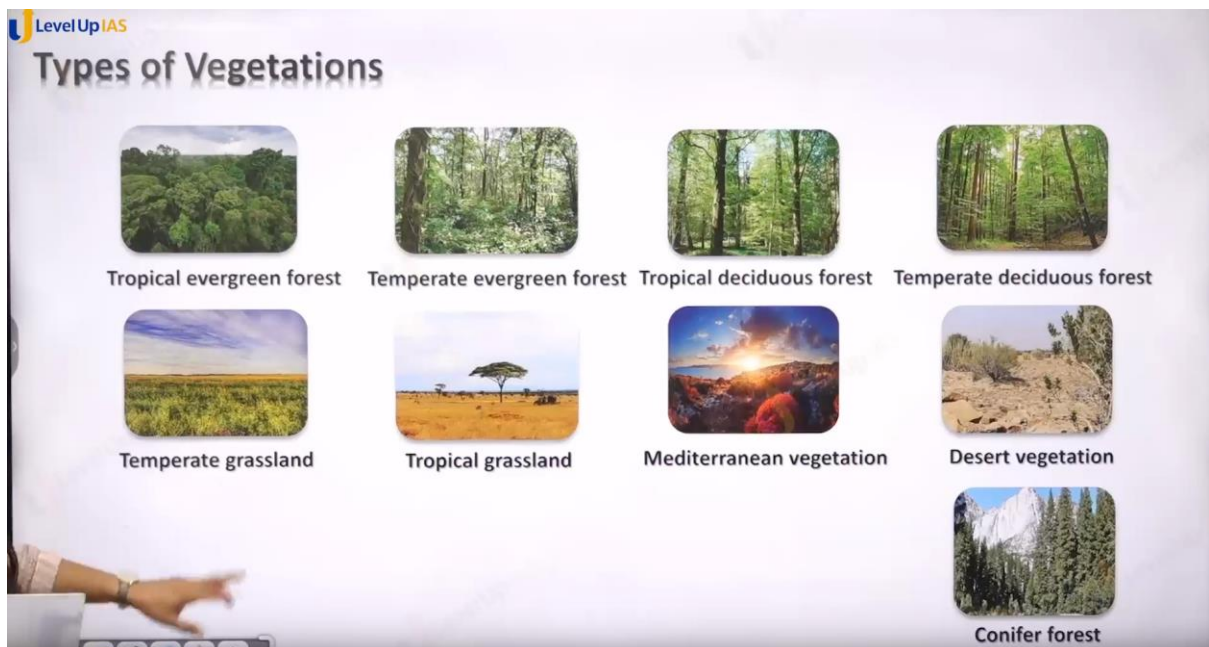
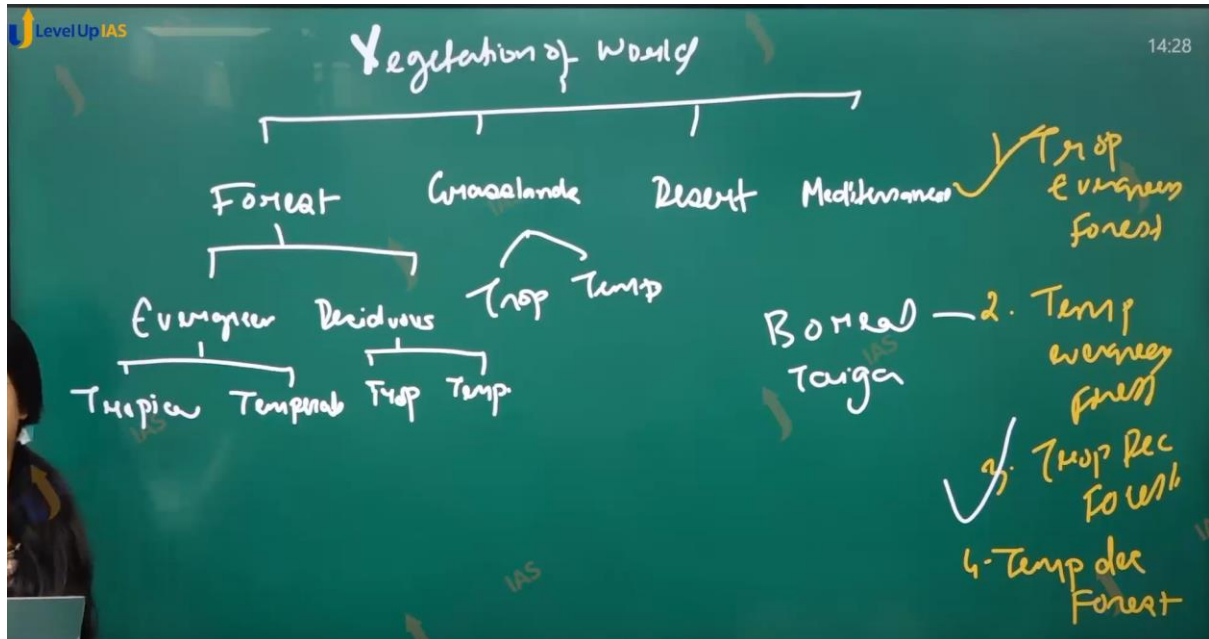


Topic – Vegetation of India and Soil of India

Dimple Nankani







LevelUp IAS

Tropical evergreen forest

It occurs in the regions near the equator

Climate is hot and receive heavy rainfall throughout the year but maximum rainfall around the Equinox. Average maximum temperature is around 30 degree Celsius and 20 degree

Because of absence of dry season trees do not shed there leaves at the same time.



Tropical evergreen forest:

1. It occurs that the region near the equator climate is hot and therefore it receives heavy rainfall throughout the year. But maximum rainfall occurred around the equinox.
2. There is absence of dray season therefore trees do not shade their leaves at same time in the season.
3. The Season of place can be described as each day the same more or less Morning is clear and bright and by afternoon sun climbs up in the sky heating the region forming dark cloud. Leading to rainfall and lightning.
4. It seen in the India Andaman and Nicobar Islands Lakshadweep and southwest side of western ghat, and northeast regions.
5. The soil of tropical evergreen forest is not fertile. As the nutrients are leached down by the rainwater which are then acquired by the plants
6. And soil does not have the major nutrients.
7. This tropical ever green forest once cut cannot be received back.

8. Ex. cutting in Southeast Asia for palm cultivation, cutting in amazon in Brazil for coffee plantations, cutting in Congo forest, for cocoa plantation.
 9. The names of species are rosewood, ebony, mahogany. The forest has mix of tree species which not easy to cut them. Some of trees are quobreak tree.
-

LevelUp IAS
Temperate evergreen forest

It is located in the mid-latitudinal coastal region.

They are commonly found along the eastern margin of the continents.

Common in - south east USA, South China and East Brazil

Comprise of hard and soft wood trees

status. In India it is

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Temperate evergreen forest:

1. It is located in mid latitude and margin of continents. They comprise of sold wood and hard wood species but solfwood dominiante.
 2. They are wild used for furniture and matchstick production paper production.
 3. In India temperate every green forest are seen majorly in the Himalayas the name of species are oak pine eucalyptus.
 - 4.
-

LevelUp IAS

Tropical deciduous forest

Are the monsoon forests

It is found in the large part of India, northern Australia and in central America

Trees shed their leaves in the dry season to conserve water

The hardwood trees are found in these forests

These are useful for making furniture. Seen across the India



Tropical deciduous forest:

-
1. They are also known as monsoon forest
 2. They are two types moist deciduous forest and dry deciduous forest.
 3. They are found in large part of India, Brazil, Mexico, some parts of Africa, Australia.
 4. Tree sheds their leaves to conserve their moisture. There is a mixture of softwood and hard wood. They are used for furniture.
 5. Ex teak, sal, neem, Shisham.
-

Levelup IAS

Temperate deciduous forest

Found in higher latitudes.

Shed their leafs in dry season

North part of USA, China, New Zealand and Western Europe.

Trees - oak, ash, beech. In India it is found in Western Ghats.



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Temperate deciduous forest:

-
1. It is found in higher latitudes 15 degrees north and south.
 2. Tree shed their leaves in dry season, They are found along the margin of temperate ever green forest, ex USA, China New Zealand, western Europe, Chile,
 3. Species oak, ash, beech
-

Level Up IAS

Temperate Grassland

These are found in the mid-latitudinal zones and in the interior part of the continents.

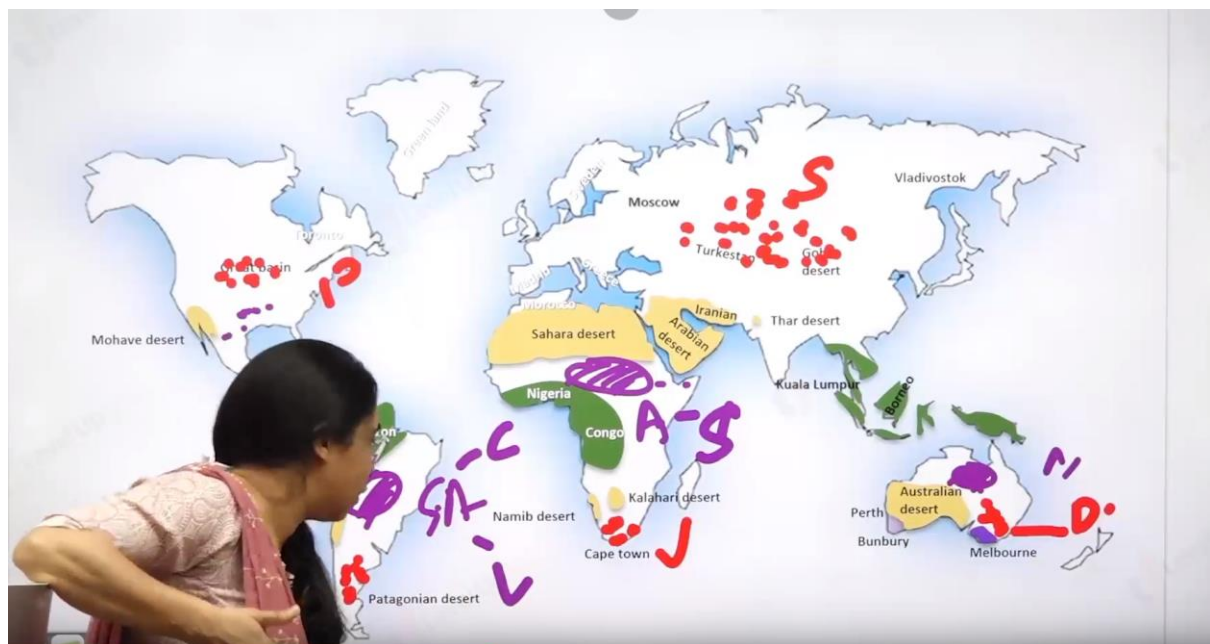
Usually, grass here is short and nutritious.

In steppe, Climate is extreme, rainfall is scanty and the people used to be nomadic.

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anyaneshwar.mogal.ias@gmail.com



17:57 / 02:14:20



The violet ones are tropical grassland
And the red ones are temperate grassland.

Levelup IAS

Tropical grassland



Found on the either side of the equator and extend till the tropics

Grasses here are very tall, about 3 to 4 metres in height
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dnyaneshwar.mogal.ias@gmail.com

Savannah grasslands of Africa are of this type. In India is it seen in Peninsular Plateau

Tropical Grasslands:

-
1. They are found on either side of tropics, where there is moisture stress.
 2. These grasslands are very tall and may reach 3 to 4 m height. Tropical grasslands are not pure grassland, there is a mixture of tree and grassland.
 3. Grasses have become resistant to fire due to a lot of fire in the dry seasons, therefore this ecosystem is also called fire climax community.
 4. Tropical grassland are not nutrients compared to temperate grasslands. Because grass need cold climate for better nutrition as well as the soil in region of tropical grassland is not as nutrient rich
 5. Ex: savannah in Africa, Llanos south America, Campos in south America.
-



Temperate Grassland

These are found in the mid-latitudinal zones and in the interior part of the continents.

Usually, grass here is short and nutritious.

Climate is extreme, rainfall is low and the people used to be nomadic.

Temperate grassland is seen in Himalayas.

Temperate Grassland:

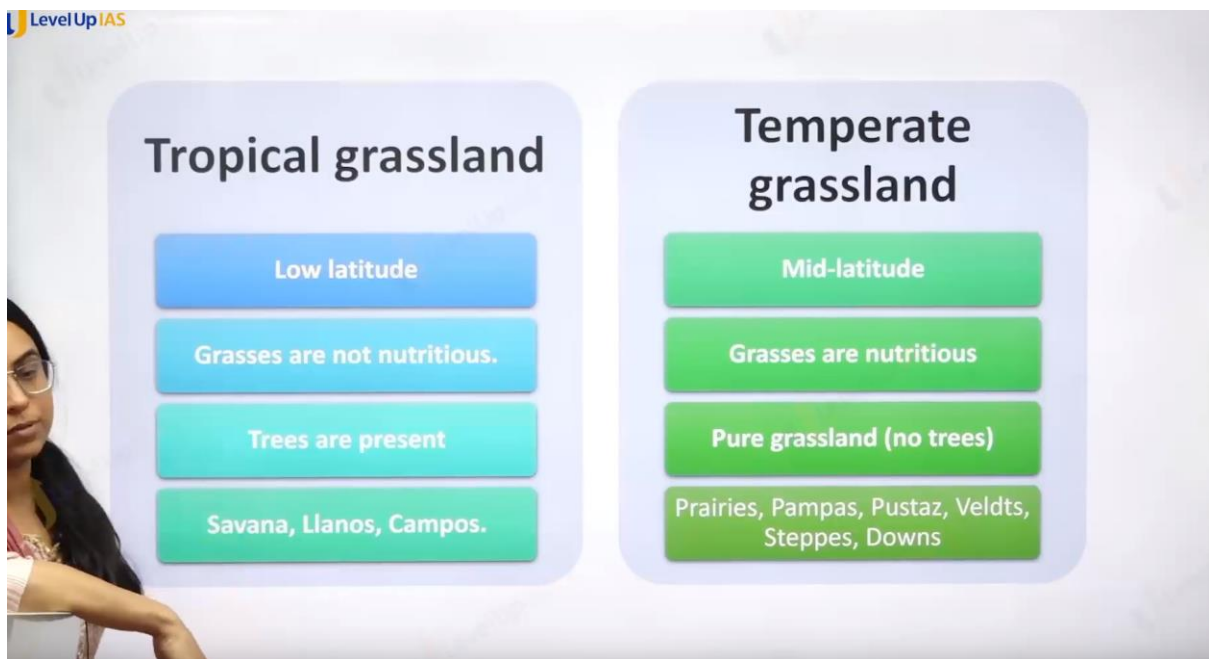
1. They are found in mid latitude zone in the inner part of continent
2. The grasses are usually short usually nutritious ex: steppes in Russia, pampas in Argentina, Pustaz in Hungary, veldts in South Africa. Prairies

in north America (they are little on the wetter side) and downs in Austria.

3. They are pure grassland unlike savannah.

4.

Difference



Level Up IAS

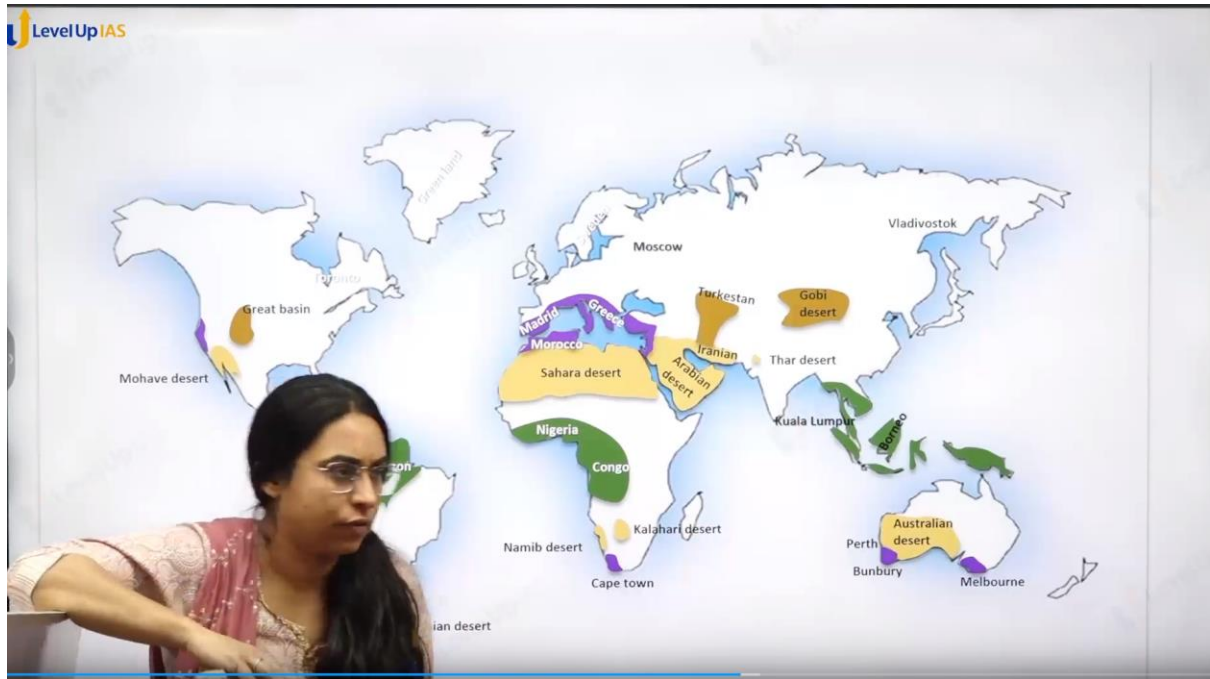
Desert vegetation



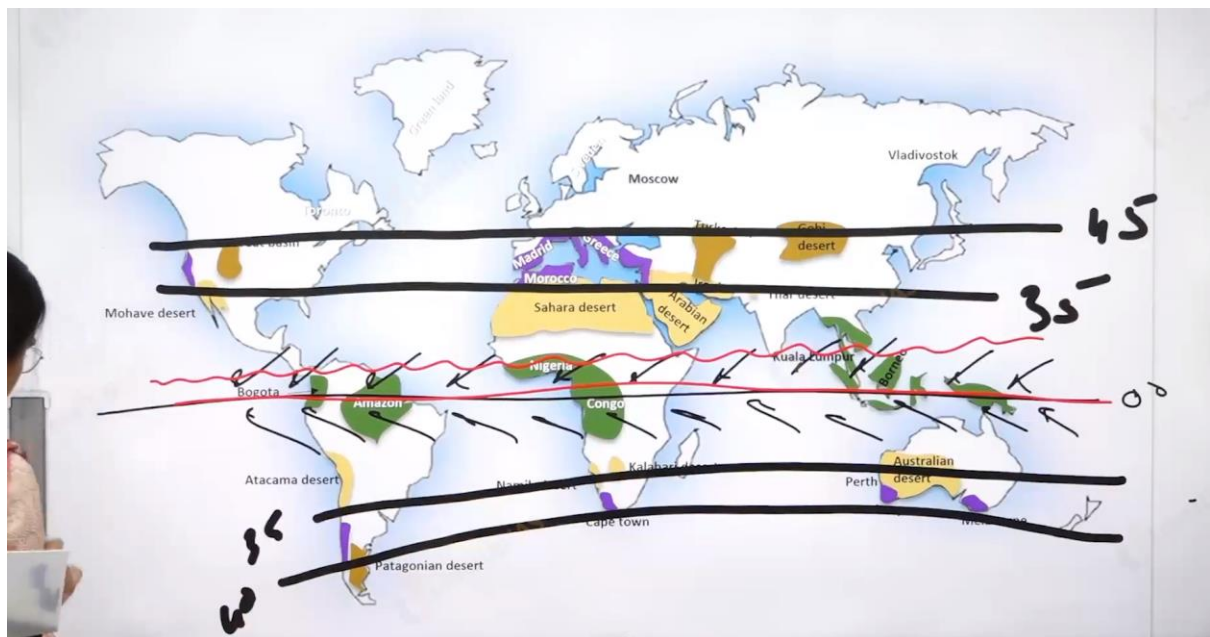
- It found in the desert
- Vegetation is adapted to scanty rain and scorching heat
- The vegetation cover is scarce
- In India it is seen in Ladakh, Rajasthan, Gujarat

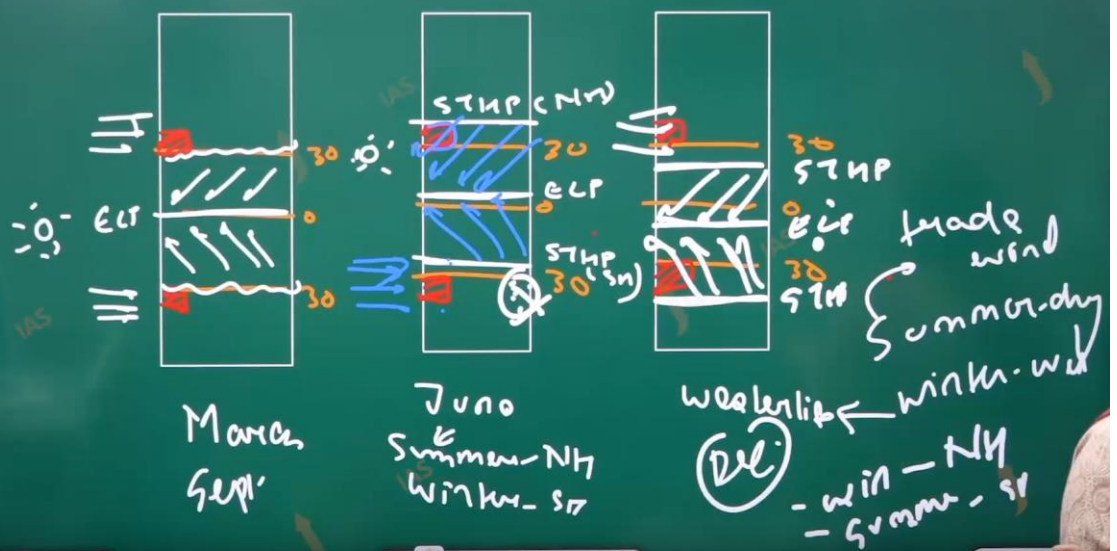
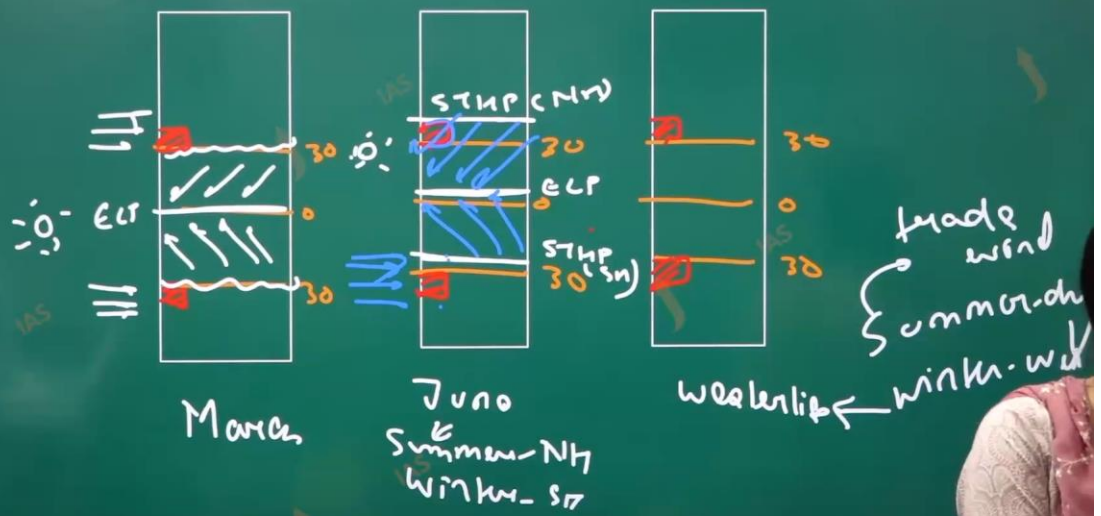
Desert Vegetation:

1. It was found in the desert. The vegetation is scarce and vegetation are adapted to water stress. In India desert vegetation is seen in the Ladakh, Rajasthan, Gujarat.
2. The tree adaptation is like long tap roots to reach ground water, horizontal to search water. Seed lies dormant for years, and quickly germinate when it rains. Tree store water in the root stem leaves fruit and they are called succulent.
3. Leaves they become small and they can become Thorn or they can become waxy and leather with sunken stomata to conserve the water loss.



It is show in the purple color.





LevelUp IAS

Mediterranean vegetation



Found in west and south west margins of the continents

Areas around the Mediterranean, California in the USA, south west Africa, south western, South America and South west Australia.

It has warm and dry climate, mild and wet winter

Citrus fruits such as oranges, figs, olives and grapes are commonly cultivated. Evergreen oak trees are also present. It is not seen in India

Mediterranean vegetation:

1. It found the in the western side of continent between 35 – 43 degrees north and south.
2. It was found in the Mediterranean climate which has special conditions like rainfall in winter due to westerlies winds dry condition in the summer due to offshore trade winds.
3. The Change in the pattern is due to shifting pressure belt with apparent shift of sun.
4. It seen the area of Mediterranean coast, California of USA, southwest Africa, southwest Africa, southwest America, the southern part of Australia.
5. The vegetation grown here are citrus fruits like oranges and gigs olive jalapeno, grapes, ever green oak tree also present this type of vegetation is not seen in India.
6. It also known as sclerophylls

LevelUp IAS

Conifer forest



In the higher latitudes ($50^{\circ} - 70^{\circ}$) on upper altitude.

It has tall, softwood evergreen trees.

Woods of these trees are very useful for making pulp, paper newsprint, and match boxes.

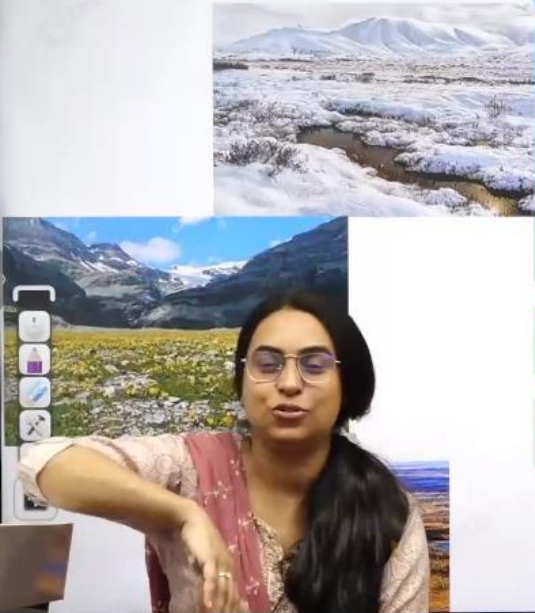
aneshwar mogal
aneshwar.mogal.ias@gmail.com
e.g. - Chir, pine, cedar. In India it is seen along Himalayas

01:42:34 / 02:14:29

Conifer forest/ vegetation:

-
1. It was found in the higher latitudes $60-70$ degrees north and in upper latitudes. It has tall soft wood ever green trees. Wood is used for making pulp paper newspapers. Chir pine and cedar it seen along the Himalayas.
-

Level Up 145
Tundra Vegetation



- Coldest biome and very fragile biome on Earth
- Temperature is below freezing for most of the year. Its frozen layer of ground is called permafrost.
- Unique due to its harsh climate and limited vegetation and animal life.
- Plants which grow in the tundra include grasses, shrubs, herbs, and lichens
- Animals in the tundra have small tails as well as ears.
- Areas: South of Arctic Region: Canada and Siberia. In India it is seen along Himalayas

Tundra Vegetation:

1. Coldest biome. And very fragile biome on earth
2. The temperature is below the freezing point of water for most of the year and therefore the frozen layer of ground is called frame forest.
3. It is a unique vegetation which adapted to harsh life /climate therefore it has limited vegetation and animal life.
4. The plants that grow in tundra vegetation are grass herbs lichen shrubs.
5. The animal in tundra is small tail and small ear. It found in the region in the Canada Siberia greenland Himalayas.

2011

23. If a tropical rain forest is removed, it does not regenerate quickly as compared to a tropical deciduous forest. This is because

- (a) the soil of rain forest is deficient in nutrients
- (b) propagules of the trees in a rain forest have poor viability
- (c) the rain forest species are slow-growing

exotic species invade the fertile soil of rain forest

Ans A.

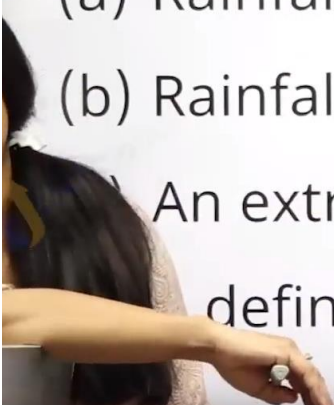
Vegetation of India:

LevelUp IAS

2012

Which one of the following is the characteristic climate of the Tropical Savannah Region?

- (a) Rainfall throughout the year
- (b) Rainfall in winter only
- (c) An extremely short dry season
- (d) definite dry and wet season



Ans d

LevelUp IAS

2013

Which of the following is/are unique characteristic/characteristics of equatorial forests?

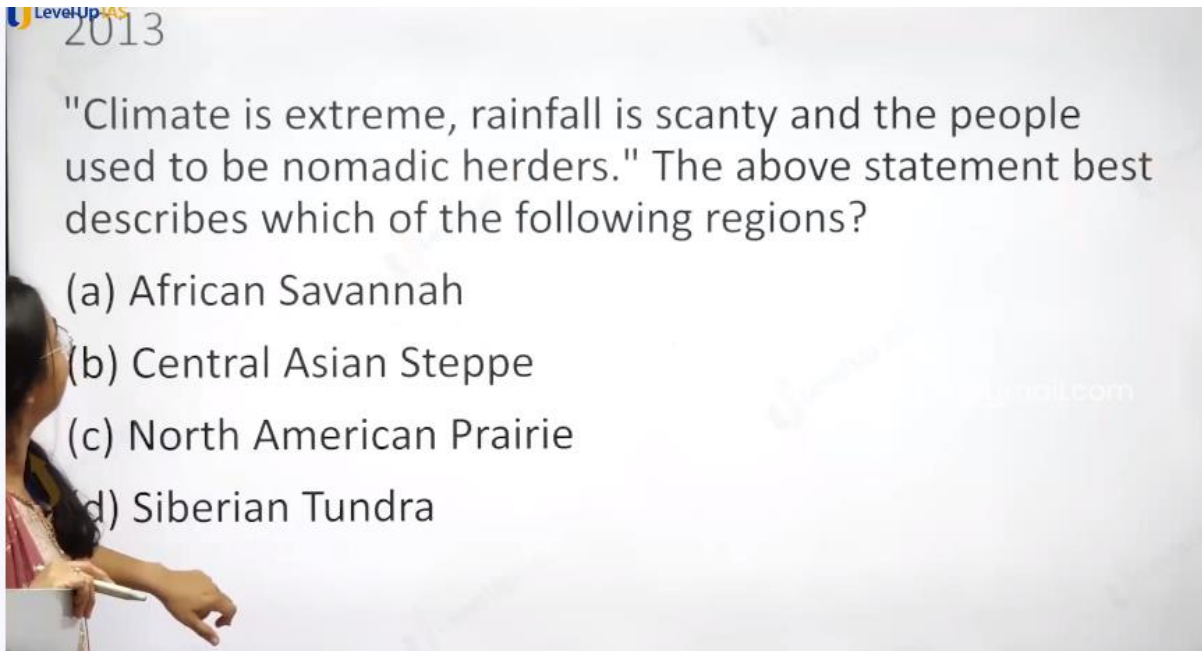
1. Presence of tall, closely set trees with crowns forming a continuous canopy
2. Coexistence of a large number of species
3. Presence of numerous varieties of epiphytes

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

01:51:47 / 02:44:00

Ans Is D

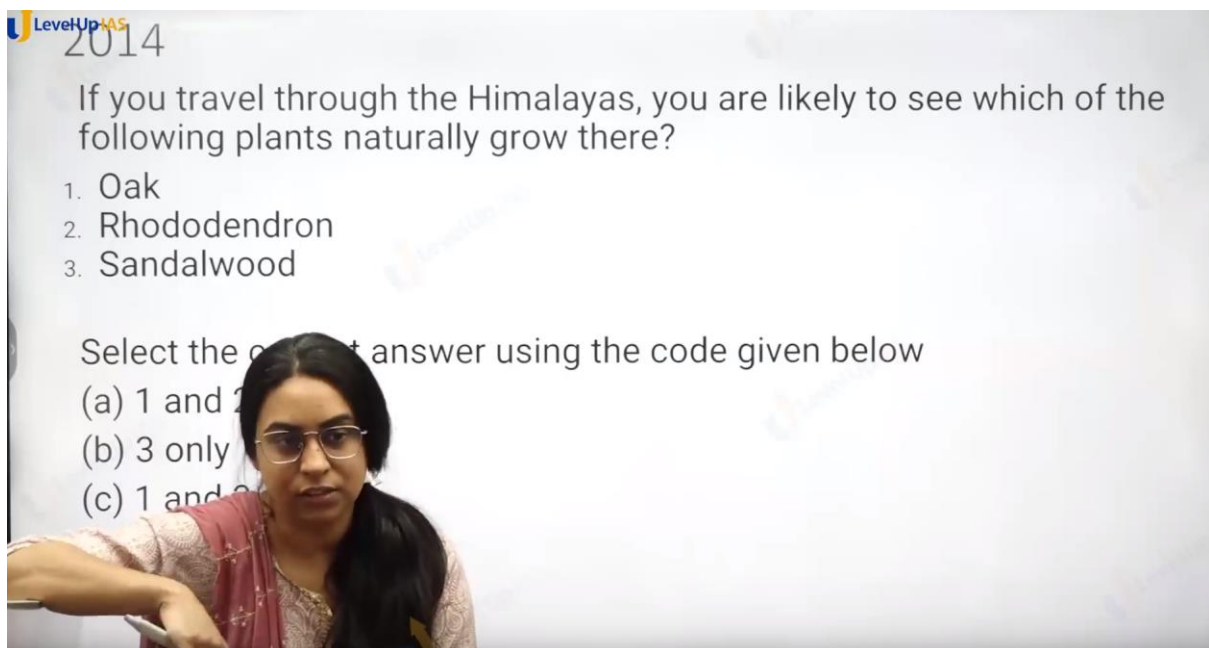


Ans B.

Tundra do not have the livestock. Not d

Prairie is good rainfall.

Savanna not extreme climate.



Ans is a not sandhood.

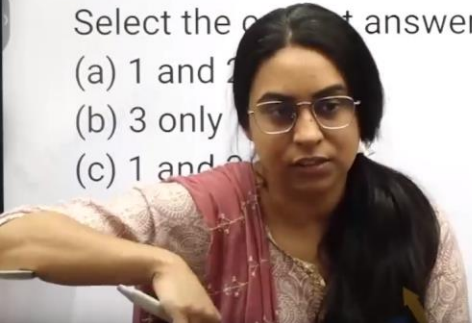
LevelUp IAS
2014

If you travel through the Himalayas, you are likely to see which of the following plants naturally grow there?

1. Oak
2. Rhododendron
3. Sandalwood

Select the correct answer using the code given below

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3



Meghalaya.

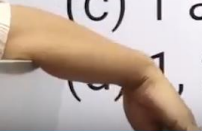
LevelUp IAS
2015

Consider the following States:

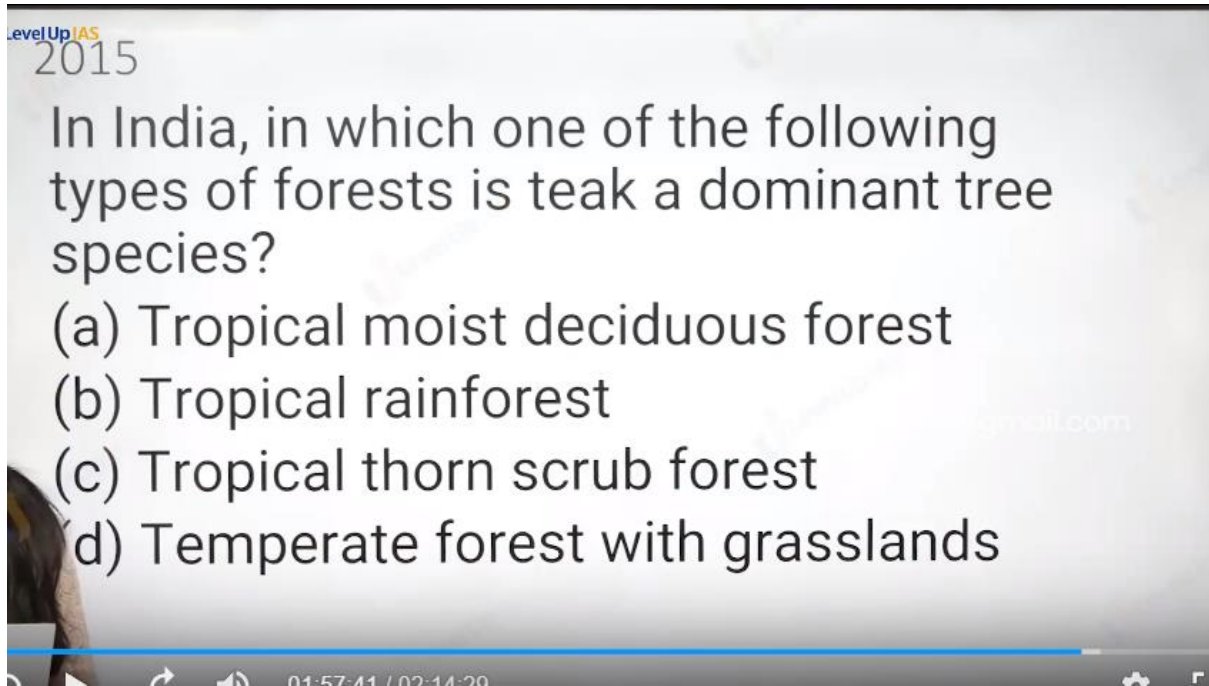
1. Arunachal Pradesh
2. Himachal Pradesh
3. Mizoram

In which of the above States do 'Tropical Wet Evergreen Forests' occur?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3



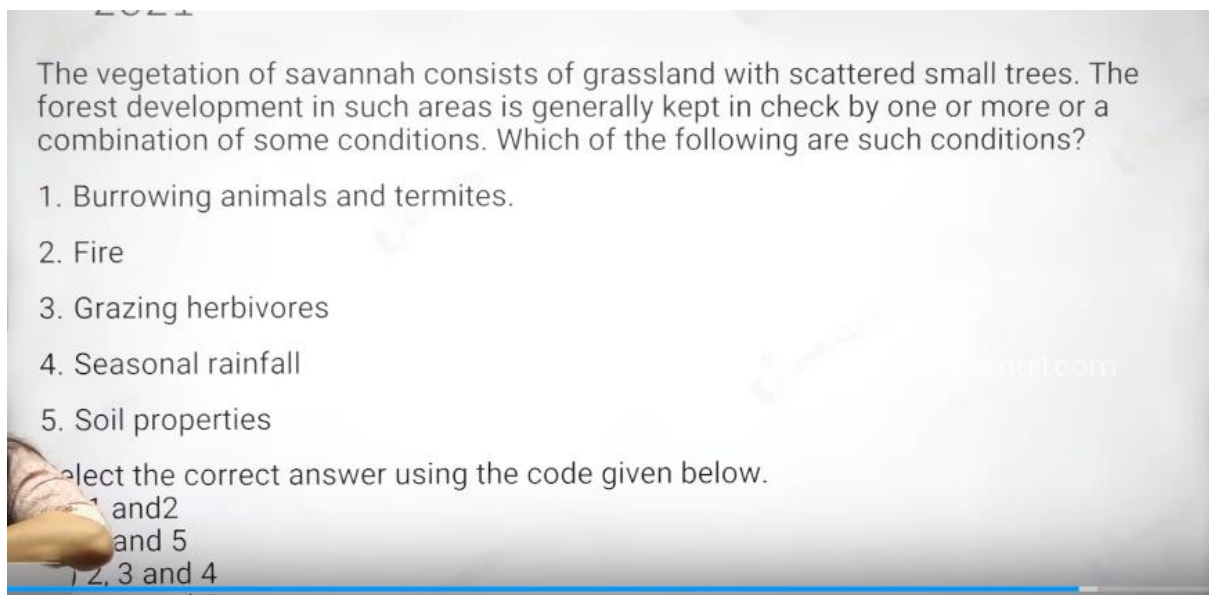
Ans is C.



Ans a.

Tropical evergreen forest : rosewood mahagani ebony

Tropical thorn scrub forest : babool cactus



Ans id C

LevelUp IAS 2021

Leaf litter decomposes faster than in any other biome and as a result, the soil surface is often almost bare. Apart from trees, the vegetation is largely composed of plant forms that reach up into the canopy vicariously, by climbing the trees or growing as epiphytes, rooted on the upper branches of trees." This is the most likely description of

- (a) Coniferous forest
- (b) Dry deciduous forest
- (c) Mangrove forest
- (d) Tropical rain forest

LevelUp IAS 2023

Consider the following statements:

Statement-I: The soil in tropical rain forests is rich in nutrients.

Statement-II: The high temperature and moisture of tropical rainforests cause dead organic matter in the soil to decompose quickly.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is Correct the explanation for Statement-I

☒ b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-I is not the correct explanation for Statement-I

c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect

Ans d. first is wrong

2018

With reference to agricultural soils, consider the following statements :

1. High content of organic matter in soil drastically reduces its water holding capacity.
2. Soil does not play any role in the sulphur cycle.
3. Irrigation over a period of time can contribute to the salinization of some agricultural land.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 3 only

(c) 1 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

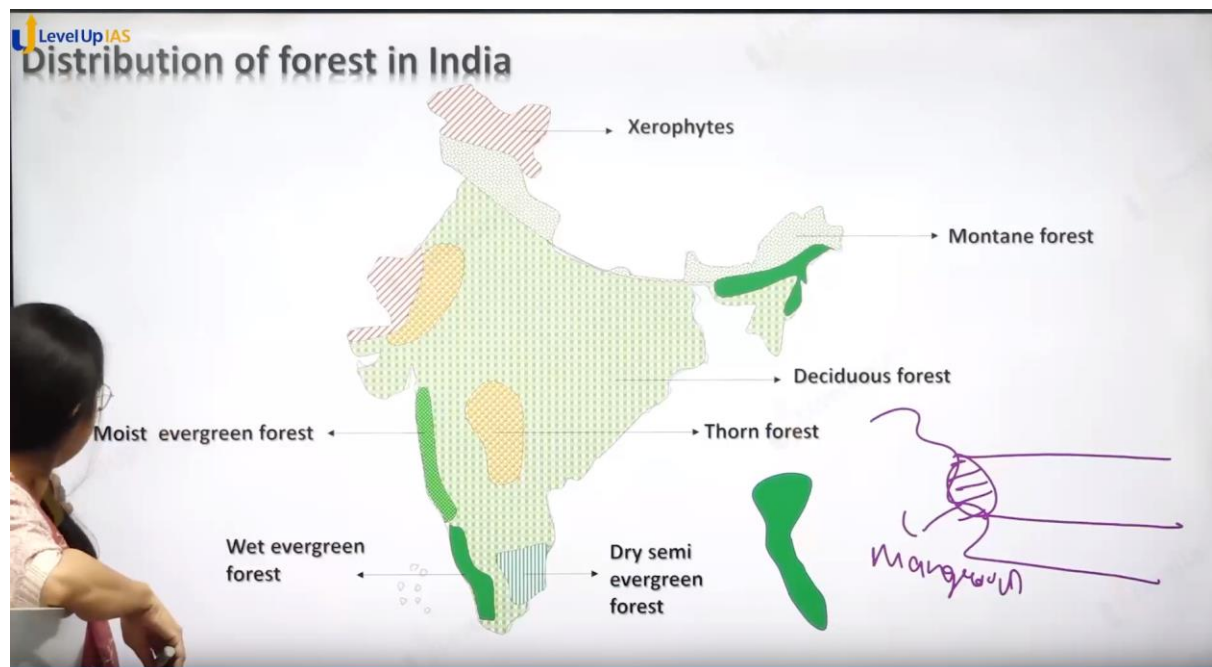
Vegetation of India:

1. You have wet ever green forest, moist ever green forest. Monsoon forest, deciduous forest, thorn forest. xerophyte. Montane forest, mangroves: -shola forest.
2. Wet ever green forest: rainfall > 350 cm/ Year
3. Moist ever green forest: rainfall >250 cm /year
4. Dry semi ever green forest: 200 cm
5. Monsoon forest: rainfall 75 -150 cm/year.
6. Dry deciduous forest: 75-100
7. moist deciduous forest: 100- 150
8. thorn forest: 75
9. xerophyte: 45 :
10. mangroves are : tidal halophytic plant.

Types of forest based on rainfall



dnyaneshwar.mogal.ias@gmail.com(8421928891)



THE MANGROVE ECOSYSTEM

Extreme Conditions and Extremely High Biodiversity

Mangrove forests are found on coastlines in tropical and subtropical areas. The mangrove tree looks a bit strange because its roots are partially above water, making the tree look like it's standing on many gnarly stilts. The roots are exposed to help the tree take in oxygen in a waterlogged environment. Fish, shrimp, crabs, and mollusks are among the organisms that take shelter within mangrove roots. This ecosystem is home to considerable biodiversity, but is unfortunately threatened by shrimp farming and rising sea levels. In some countries, shrimp farming clears large sections of mangroves to build holding tanks and processing facilities. The maps below show the changes to the mangrove ecosystem in Honduras from 1987 to 1999, where much of it has been removed to store shrimp brought in from the Gulf of Fonseca.

Mangrove forests are important nesting spots for shorebirds and migratory birds.

Great Egret
Ardea alba

Brown Pelican
Pelecanus occidentalis

Little Red Bat
Lasiurus minor

Great Blue Heron
Ardea herodias

Red Mangrove Tree
Rhizophora mangle

Coastal Protection
Mangrove forests are able to bear the brunt of storms that hit the coast. They reduce the impact of strong waves on anything that lives further inland, including humans. Mangrove trees also protect the coast from erosion by collecting sediments from rivers and ocean tides around their roots. These sediments build up and strengthen the shoreline.

The Ocean's Nursery
Mangrove ecosystems host a lot of biodiversity, in part due to the mangrove tree's strange root system. The roots serve as a nursery for the larvae of many fish species, such as barracuda, tarpon, and snook. This is where fish can develop into adults before moving out to the big, unforgiving ocean. In fact, around one-third of all marine fish species are sheltered from predators in mangrove forests as juveniles.

American Crocodile
Crocodylus scroto

Gray snapper
Lutjanus griseus

Larvae

Pink Shrimp
Farfantepenaeus duorarum

Bocourt Swimming Crab
Callinectes bocourti

Hard clam
Merccenaria mercenaria

Detritus

...that have fallen into the detritus, and are broken down to return nutrients to the water.

1987

1999

NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC

Littoral and Swamp forest

1. Wetland habitats in India:

- About 70 per cent is under paddy cultivation.
- Total area of wetland is 4 million ha.
- Two sites: Chilika Lake (Odisha) and Keoladeo National Park (Bharatpur) are protected as water-fowl habitats under the Convention of Wetlands of International Importance (Ramsar Convention)

Mangrooves:

Mangroves grow along coasts in the salt marshes, tidal creeks, mud flats and estuaries.

They have number of salt-tolerant species of plants.

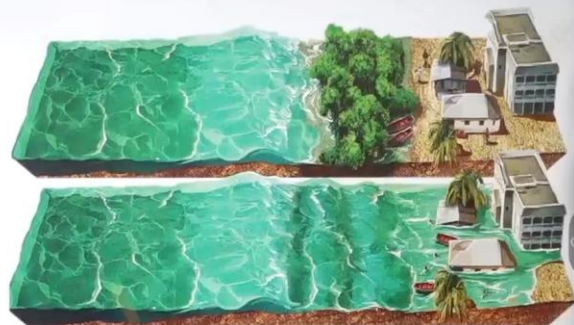
These forests give shelter to a wide variety of

rooves are found along entire coast with

es along Andaman and Nicobar

s, Sunderbans of West Bengal, Mahanadi,

and the Krishna deltas.

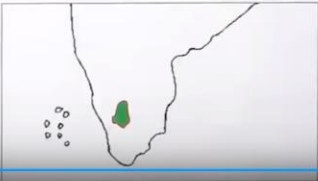


LevelUp IAS
Southern Mountain Forest

1. Southern mountain forests include the forests found in three distinct areas of Peninsular India viz; the Western Ghats, the Vindhyas and the Nilgiris.
2. As they are closer to the tropics, and only 1,500 m above the sea level, vegetation is temperate in the higher regions, and subtropical on the lower regions of the Western Ghats, especially in Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Karnataka.
3. The temperate forests are called Sholas in the Nilgiris, Anaimalai and Palani hills.
4. Some of the other trees of this forest of economic significance include, magnolia, laurel, cinchona and wattle.

Such forests are also found in the Satpura and the Maikala.





02:13:35 / 02:14:29

(35) Vegetation and Soil-II

LevelUp IAS
Southern Mountain Forest

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Southern Mountain Forest:

1.

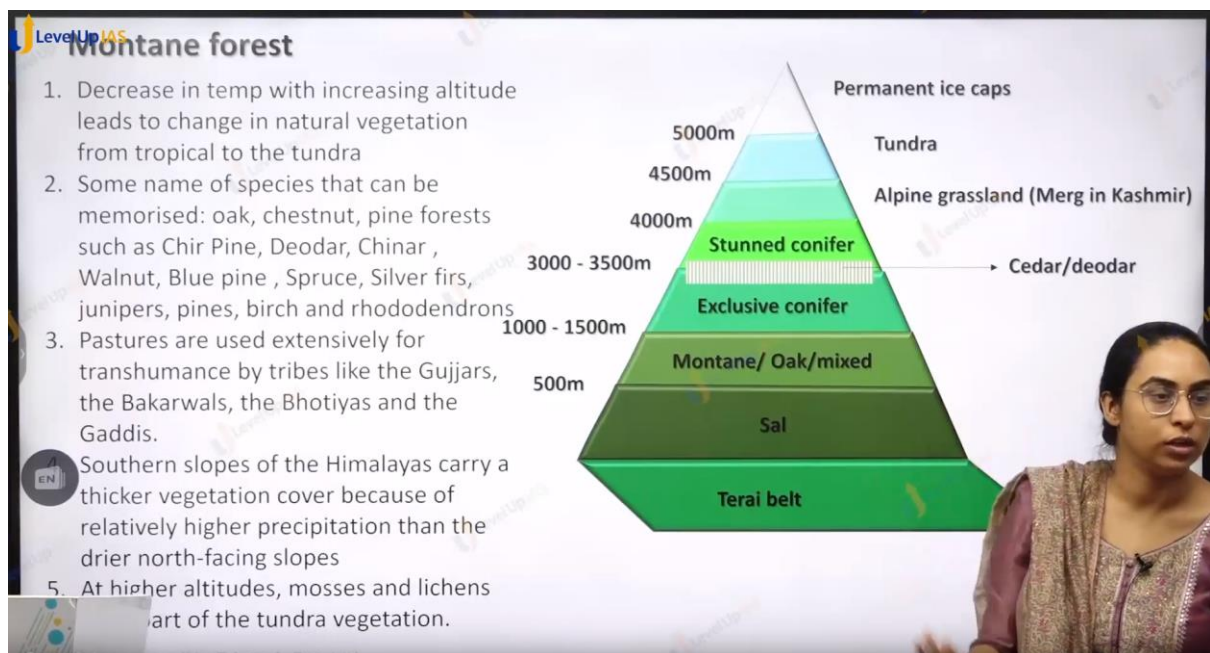
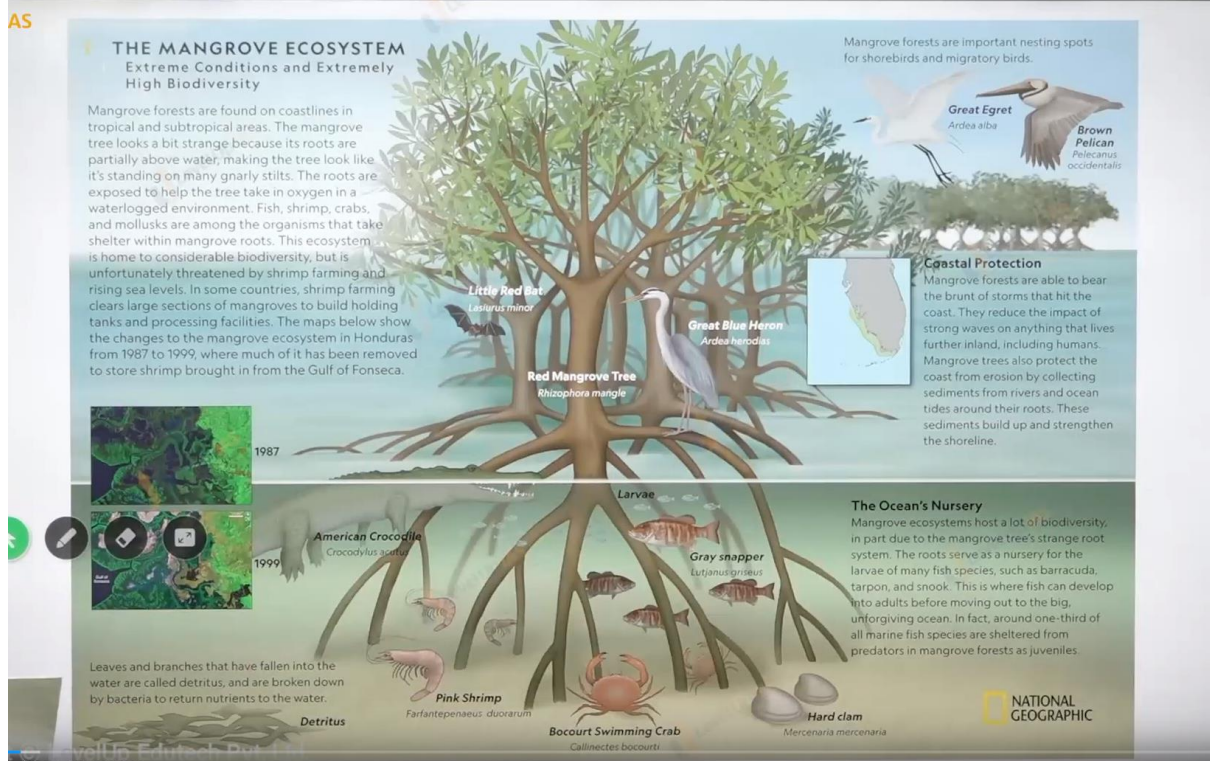
LevelUp IAS

Littoral and Swamp forest

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2. Mangrooves:
 - Mangroves grow along coasts in the salt marshes, tidal creeks, mud flats and estuaries.
 - They have number of salt-tolerant species of plants.
 - These forests give shelter to a wide variety of birds.
 - Mangrooves are found along entire coast with stretches along Andaman and Nicobar Is., Sunderbans of West Bengal, Mahanadi, Godavari and the Krishna deltas.

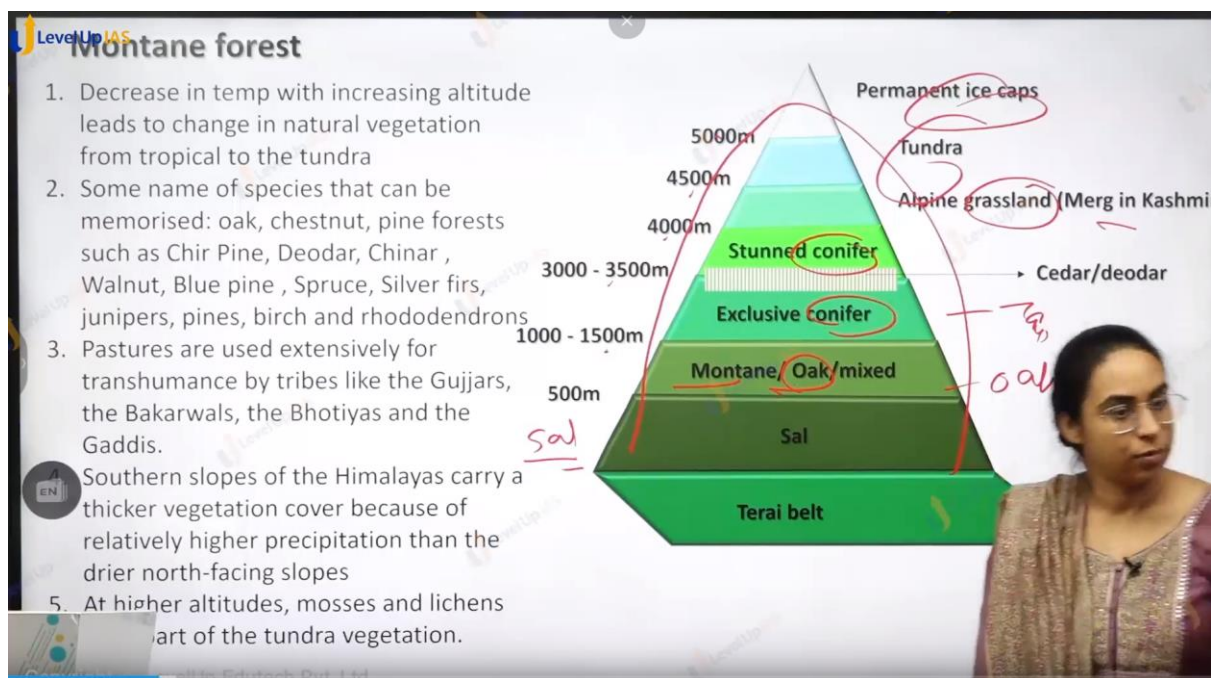


00:37:02/38:10



Indian vegetataion contains:

1. Tropical Every green forest:
2. Tropical Deciduous forest:
3. Temperate Deciduous Forest:
4. Temperate every green forest:
5. Tropical grassland:
6. Temperate grassland:
7. Tundra.:
8. Southern mountain forest:
9. Mangrove
10. Wetlands.
11. Northern montane forest:
- 12.

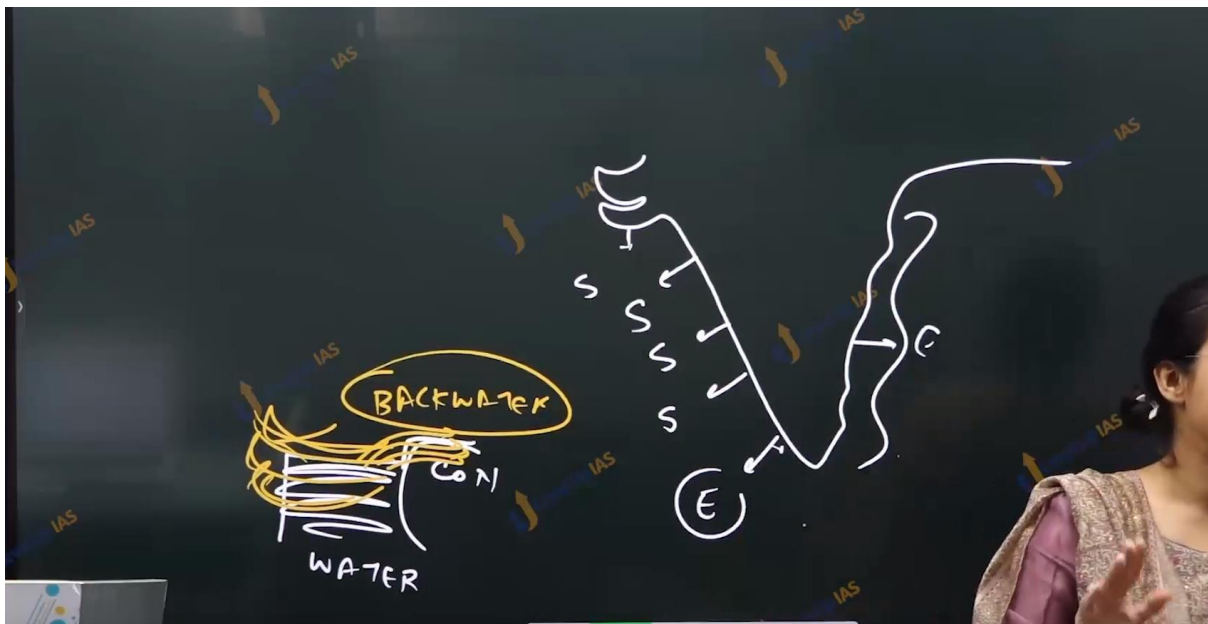


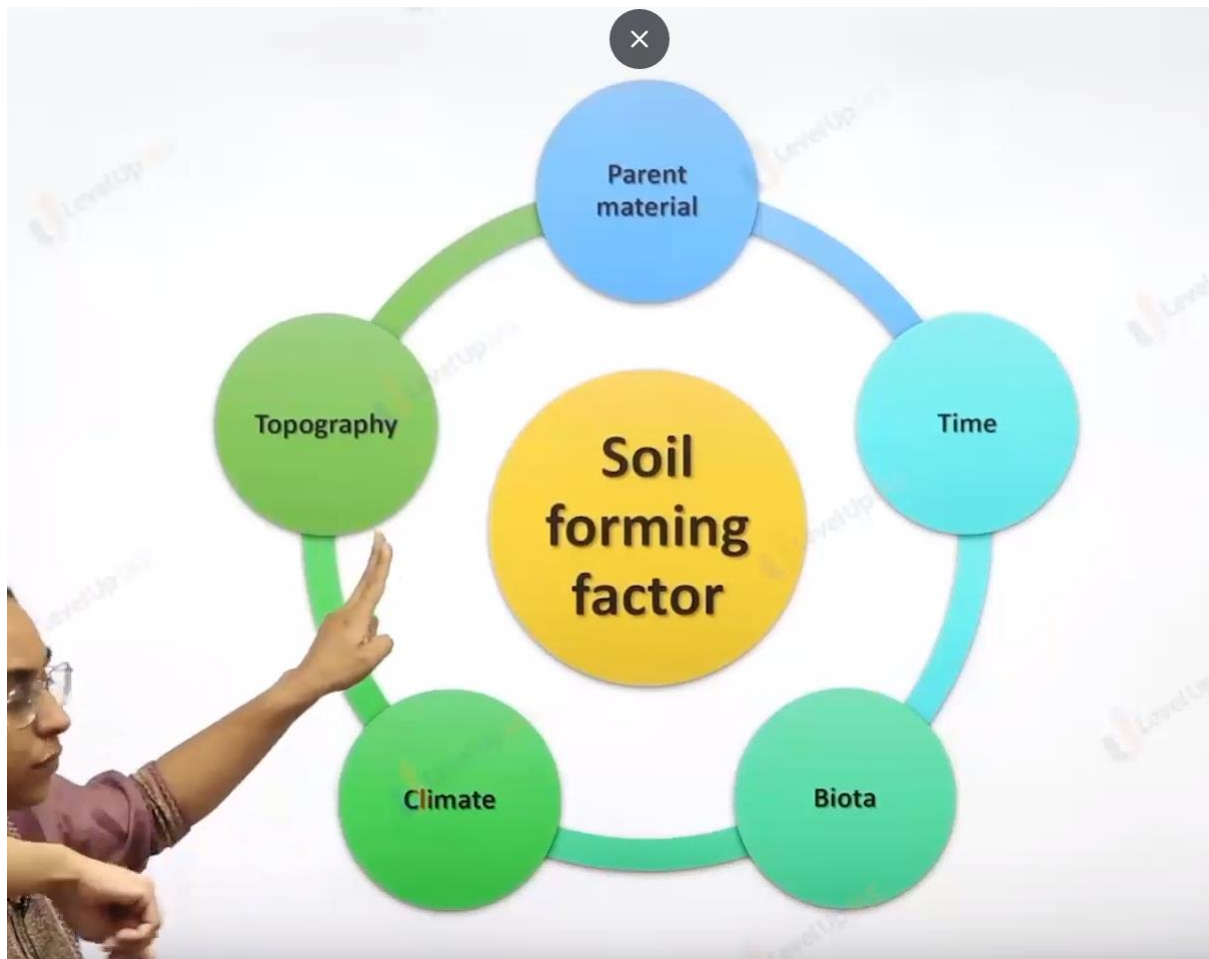
Soil

- **Weathered Parent Rock:** Weathering
- **Factors:** 5 major factors
- **Process:** Weathering, Leaching, Capillary Action.

Soil

1. Soil is not simply dirt or broken rock particles but is complex ecosystems in which factor like time, biota, climate play an important role.





S for submergence

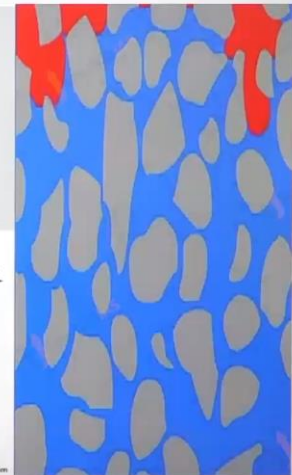
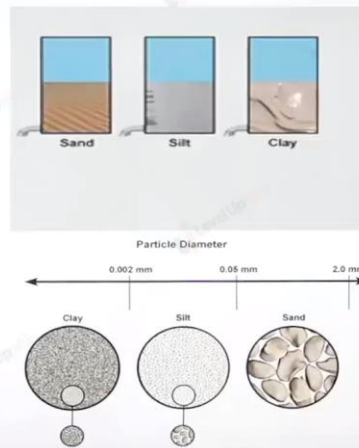
E for emergence.

Soil as a Ecosystem

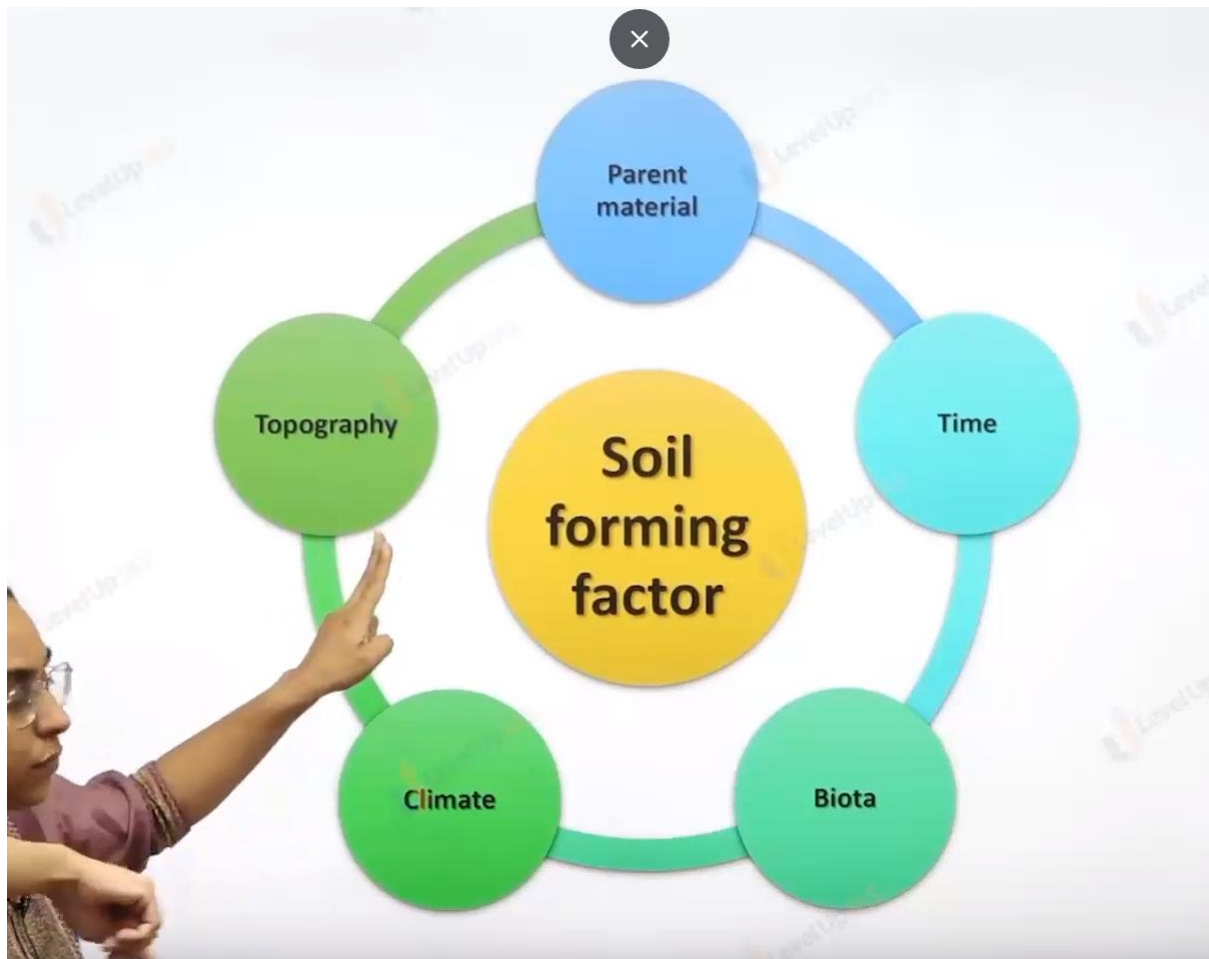


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Parent material

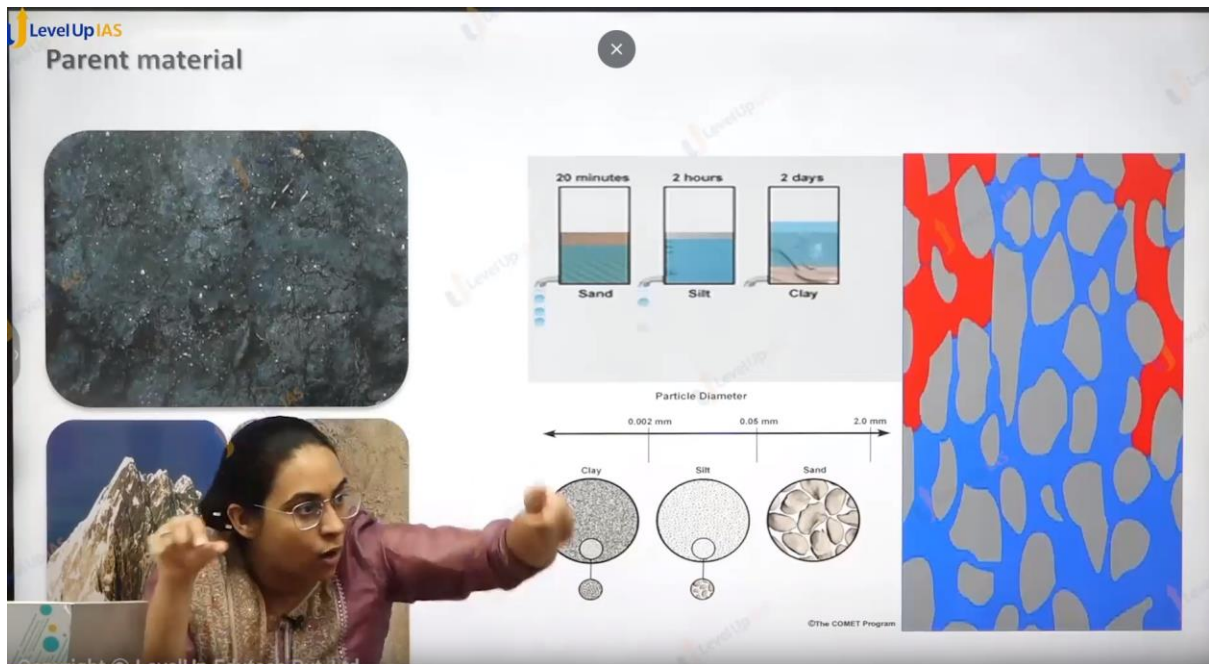


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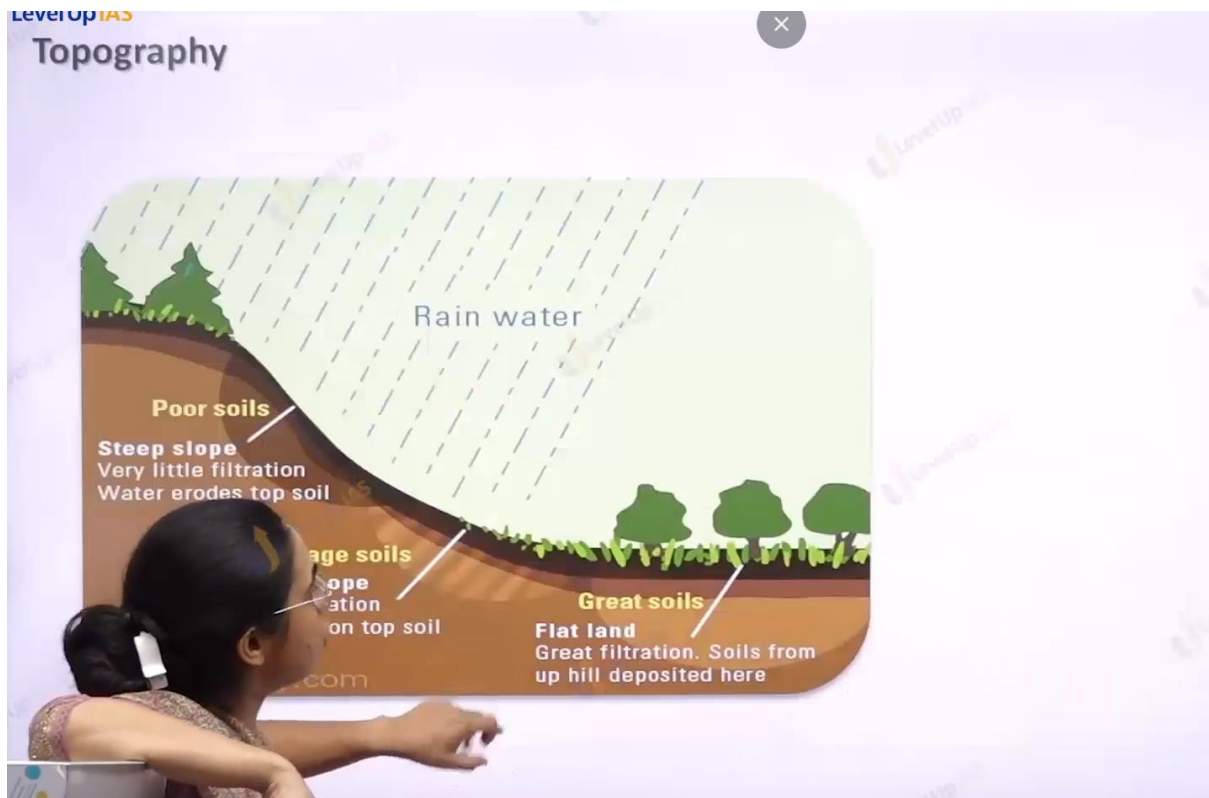
Soil Forming Process:

-
1. Weathering
 2. Translocations (water goes down in soil or earth)
 3. Leaching (nutrient go down when rains) .
 4. Unifaction.(formation of unmoors)
 5. Transformation of dirt in the soil.
 - 6.
-



Parent rock :

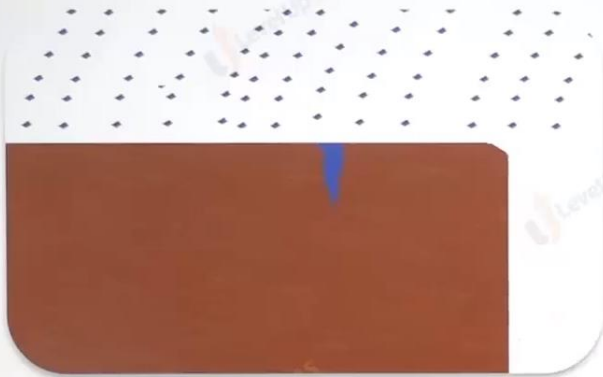
1. Parent rock determine the color of soil. The nutrient, the texture of soil , the permiability of porosity of soil.
2. Color :
 - a. Basalt give black color soil.
 - b. Granite gives red color soil.
 - c. Limestone goves white color soil.
3. Nutrients:a
 - a. Granite give iron rich soil.
 - b. Basalt gives soil which is rich in feromagnite siilliecate.
4. Perant rock determines the texture of
 - a. Soft rock ex basalt gives fine texture soil which makes soil porous. Ex black cotton soil.
 - b. Hard rock gives core texture soil. Which makes the soil permeable. Red soil.
 - c.



1. Topography affects the thickness of soil steep slope less thickness of soil gentle slope.



Climate



Freeze Thaw action

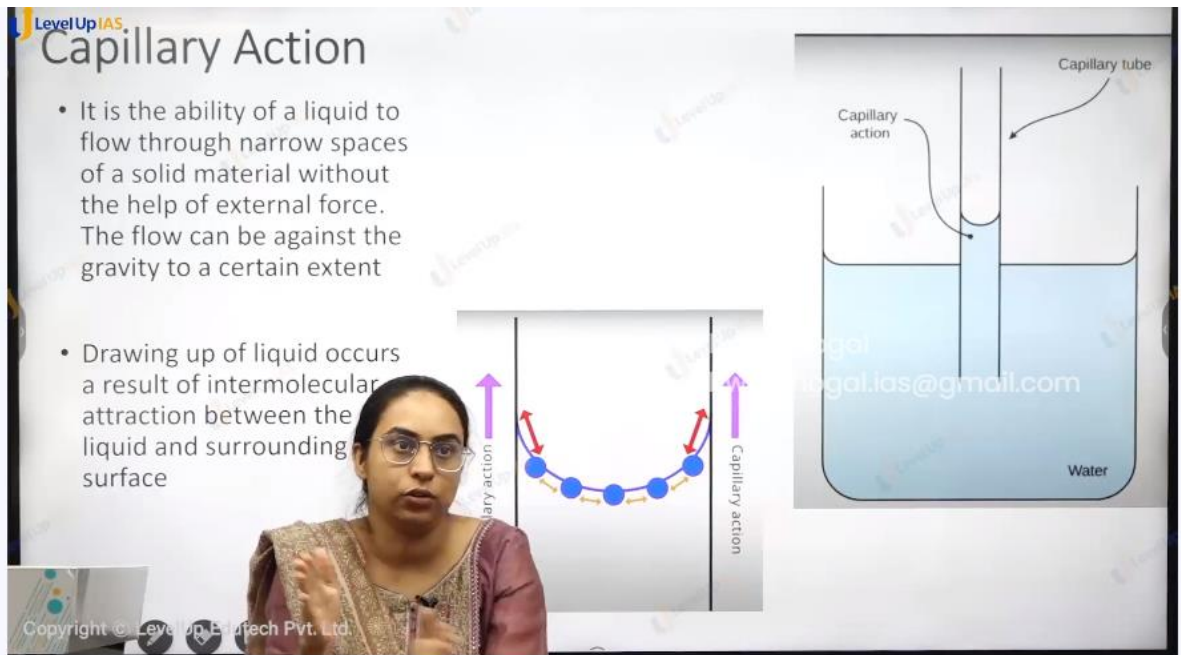
Climate



Freeze Thaw action

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Capillary Action

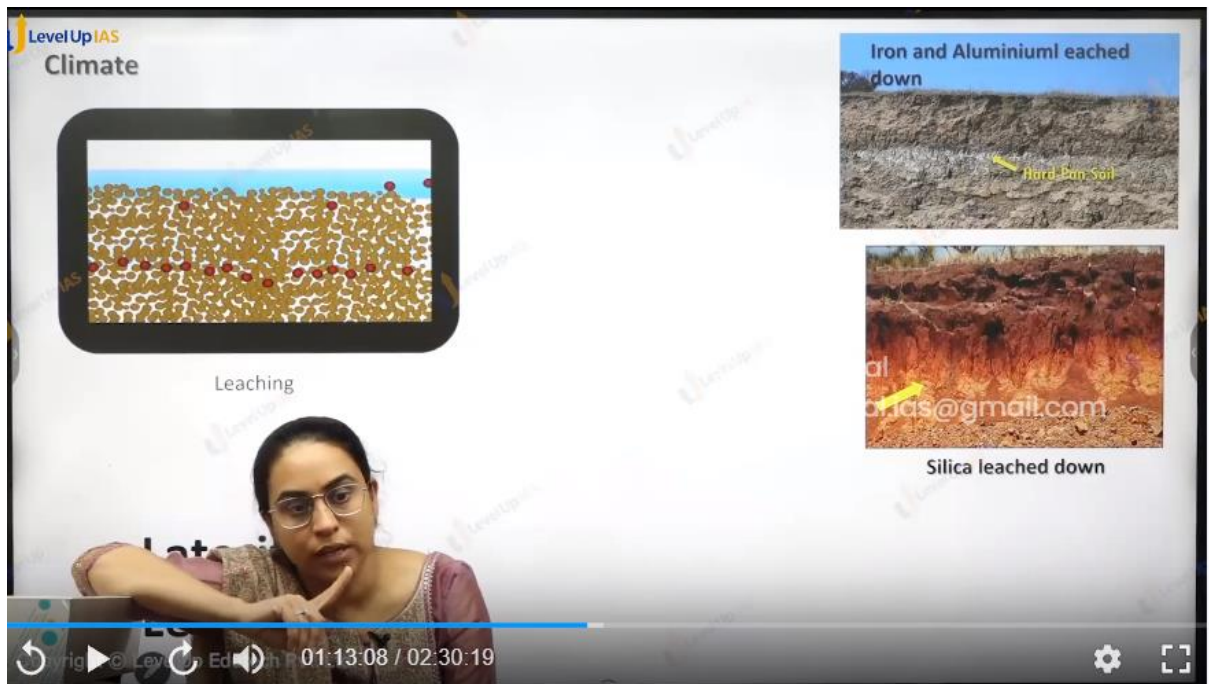
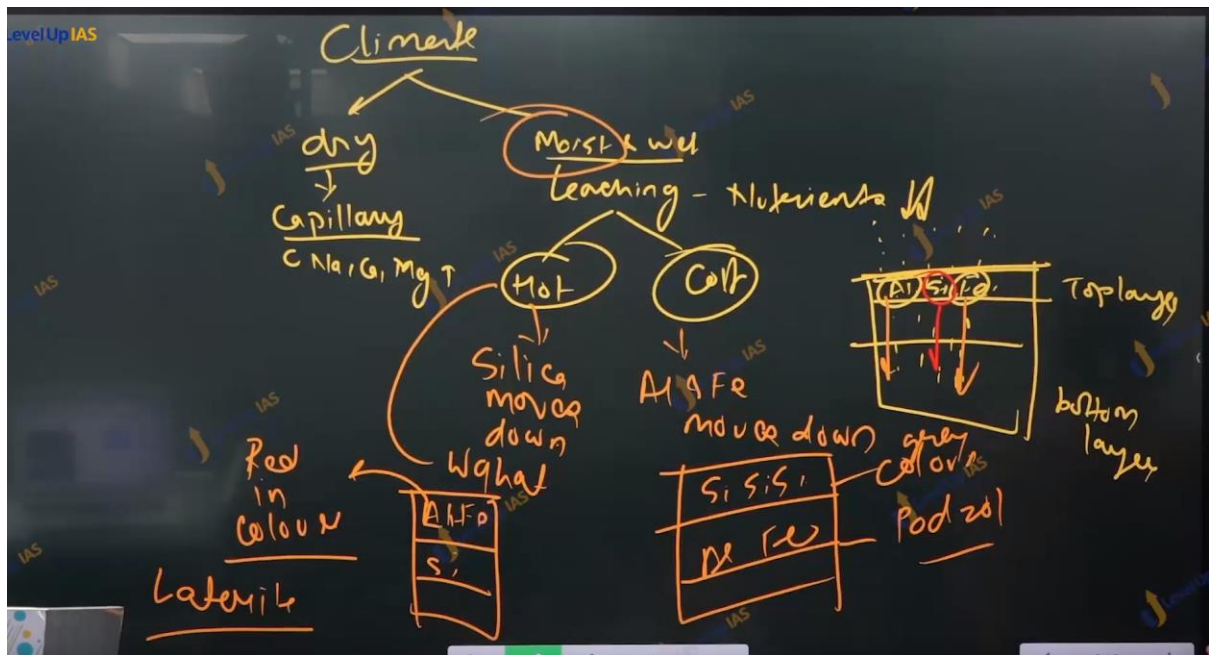
- It is the ability of a liquid to flow through narrow spaces of a solid material without the help of external force. The flow can be against the gravity to a certain extent
- Drawing up of liquid occurs a result of intermolecular attraction between the liquid and surrounding surface



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Climate:

1. Climate determines the process like type of weathering dry climate facilitate the physical weathering whereas moist climate facilitates chemical weathering. Climate also determines whether the process of leaching takes place or process the capillary action takes places.
2. Dry climate facilitates the capillary action whereas humid climate facilitates the leaching
3. Leaching refers to a process where the nutrients are dissolved in the rainwater, and it moves top layer to the lower layers.
4. Leaching very slow process and it generally seen in the area that has more rainfall than evaporations.

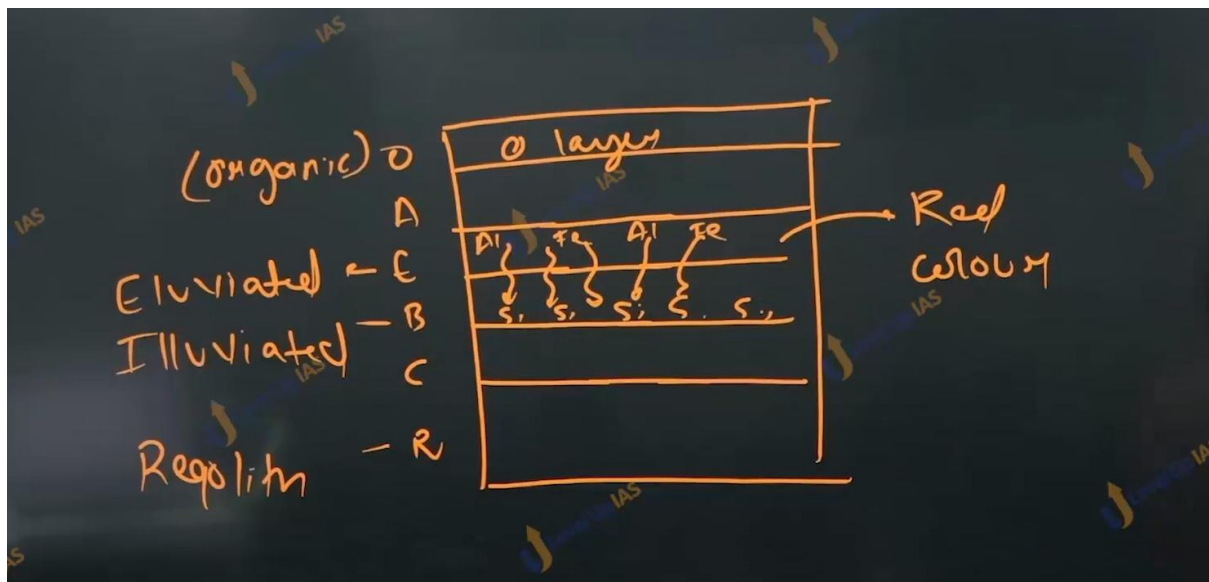


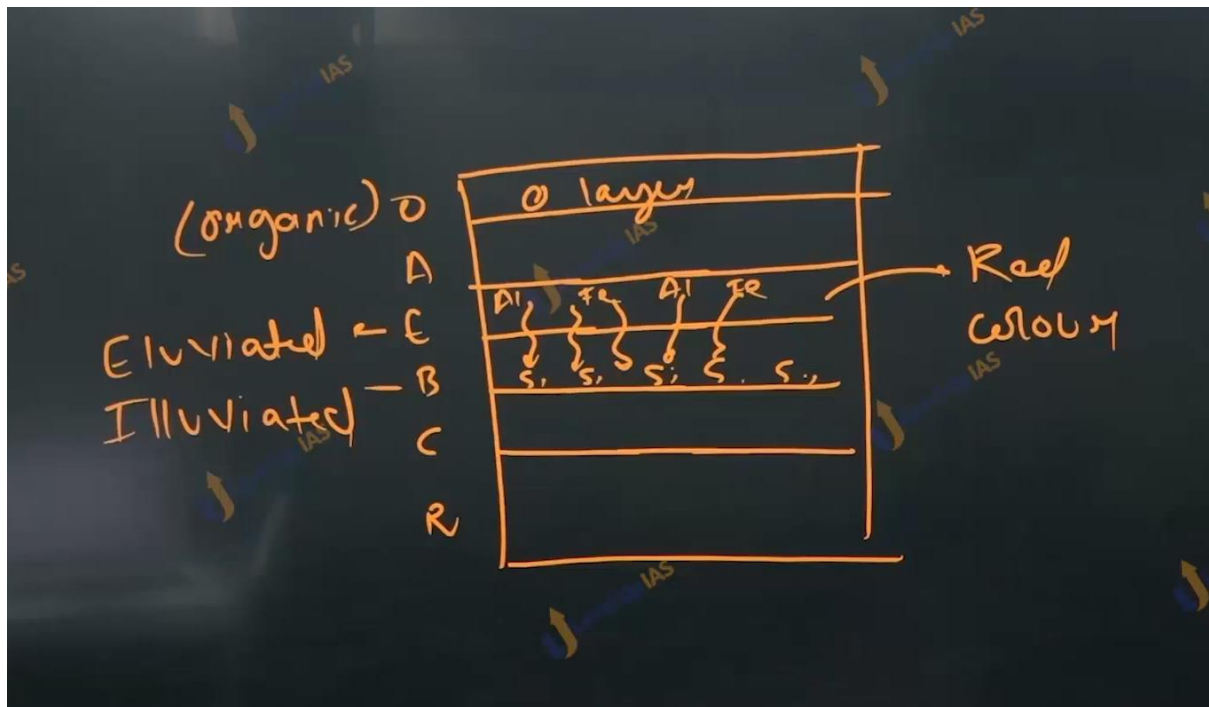
Leaching :

1. Leaching can be of 2 type that is Lateralization and podzolization.

Lateralization:

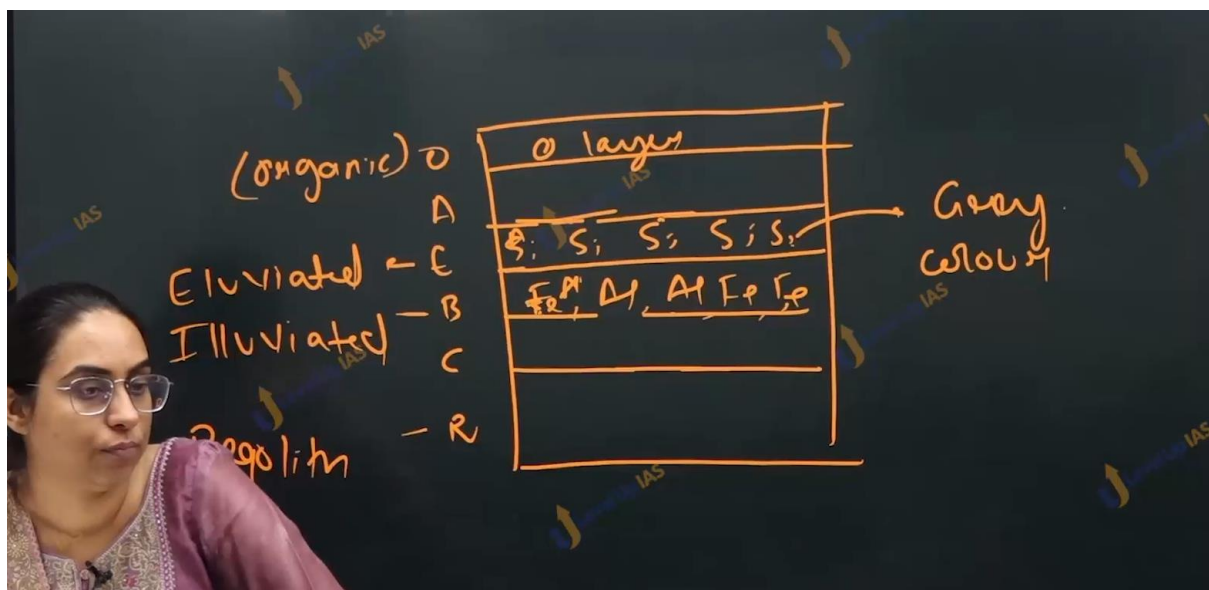
1. In the region of hot and moist conditions silica is leached down and iron and aluminum oxides are seen in the top layers.
2. Which makes the soil appears red in color such soil is called as laterized soil in places that have alternate wet and dry conditions. Such as it is seen in western ghat and eastern ghat.
3. Laterization soil is used for brick making it also supports forestry and some type of plantation of agricultural cultivation of rubber, coffee, tea.
4. Unlike the red soil which is red in color due to parent material, laterized soil is red in color due to the process of leaching.





Podzolization:

1. In the area of cold and humid conditions, iron and aluminum is leached whereas silica remains in the top layer this makes the soil. Gray in color. It is seen in India in the top reaches of Himalayas
2. Podzolic is generally seen in temperate regions.



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2012

Consider the following statements : If there were no phenomenon of capillarity

1. It would be difficult to use a kerosene lamp
2. One would not be able to use a straw to consume a soft drink
3. The blotting paper would fail to function
4. The big trees that we see around would not have grown on the Earth

Which of the statements given above are correct?

a) 1 and 3 only

b) 2 and 4 only

c) 3 and 4 only

d) 1, 2 and 4 only

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Options are not visible.

Option is c 3 and 4

Option d is all of above.

4. The big trees that we see around

Which of the statements given above

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only

(b) 1, 3 and 4 only

(c) 3 and 4 only

(d) 1, 2 and 4 only

Ans is b.

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2013

Which of the following statements regarding laterite soils of India are correct?

1. They are generally red in colour.
2. They are rich in nitrogen and potash.
3. They are well-developed in Rajasthan and UP.
4. Tapioca and cashew nuts grow well on these soils.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

(a) 1, 2 and 3
(b) 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1 and 4
(d) 2 and 3 only

EN

01:38:50 / 02:30:19

Ans is c.

r

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2018

With reference to agricultural soils, consider the following statements :

1. High content of organic matter in soil drastically reduces its water holding capacity.
2. Soil does not play any role in the sulphur cycle.
3. Irrigation over a period of time can contribute to the salinization of some agricultural lands.

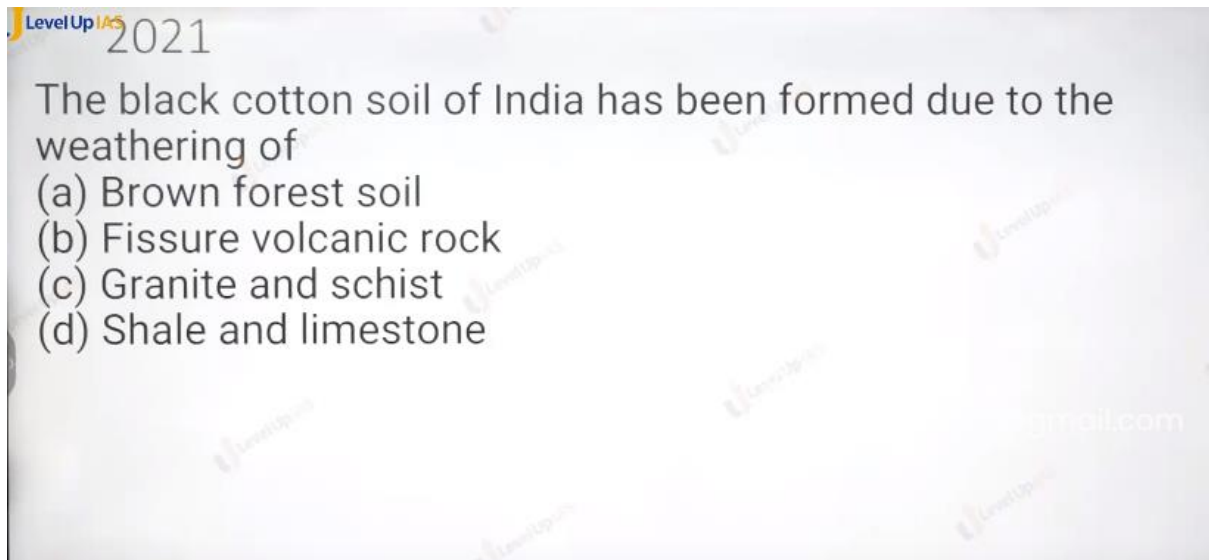
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

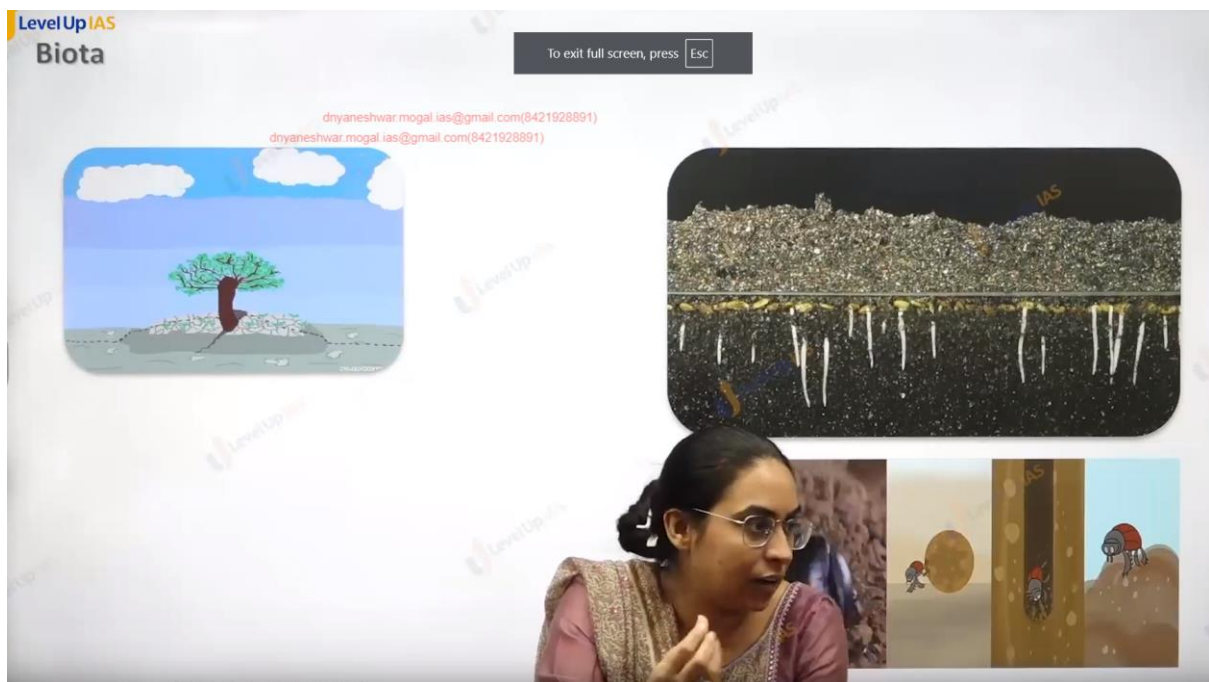
EN

01:42:28 / 02:30:19

ans id b 3 only



Ans is b : granite red soil.



Biota:

-
1. The tree breaks the rock and leads to weathering. Earthworm can turn the soil. And helps in bio terbations.
 2. The accumulation of humas because the decomposition of leaves steam shrubs etc.

3. Whether humus keep accumulating or would be decomposed depends on bacterial acidity. In the region high temperatures high bacterial activity leads to disintegration of humus containing to less fertility of soil.
 4. Whereas in the temperate region more accumulation of humus soil is very fertile. Ex. the soil in temperate grasslands. Steppes black sea.
 - 5.
-



O horizon
Loose and partly
decayed organic
matter

A horizon
Mineral matter
mixed with
some humus

E horizon
Zone of eluviation
and leaching

B horizon
Accumulation of
clay, iron and
aluminum
from above;
zone of illuviation

C horizon
Partially altered
parent material

R horizon
Unweathered
parent material



Soil

Regolith

Bedrock

O horizon
Loose and partly
decayed organic
matter

A horizon
Mineral matter
mixed with
some humus

E horizon
Zone of eluviation
and leaching

B horizon
Accumulation of
clay, iron and
aluminum
from above;
zone of illuviation

C horizon
Partially altered
parent material

R horizon
Unweathered
parent material



Soil

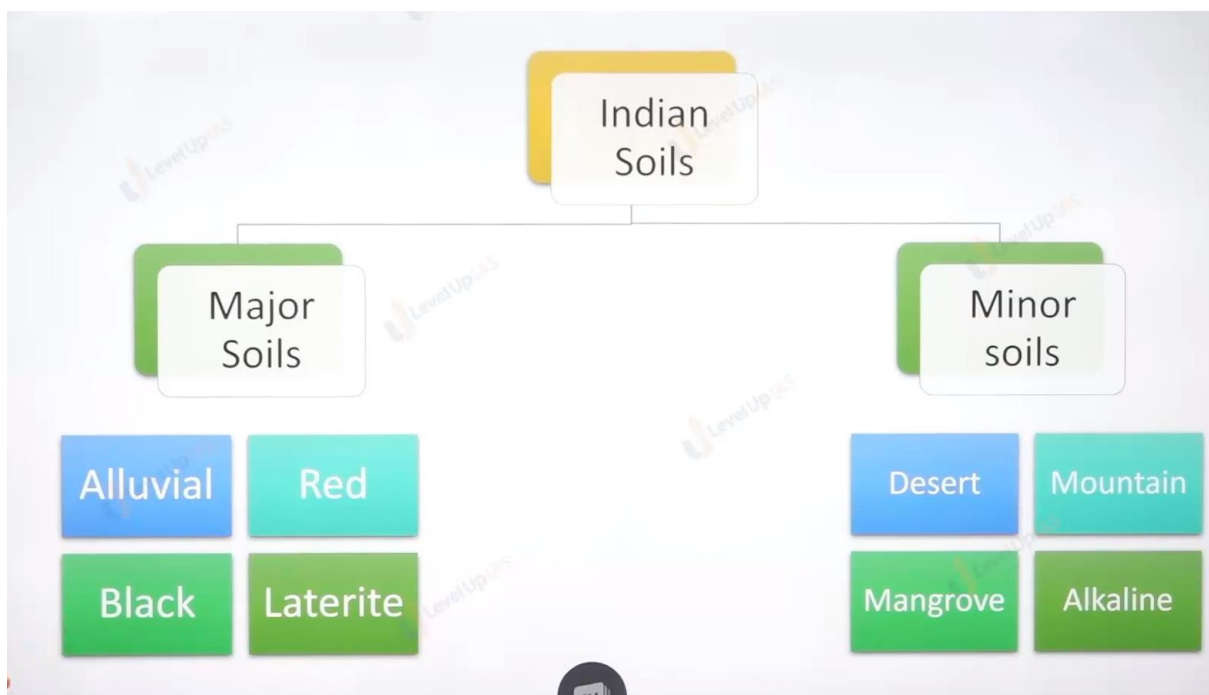
Regolith

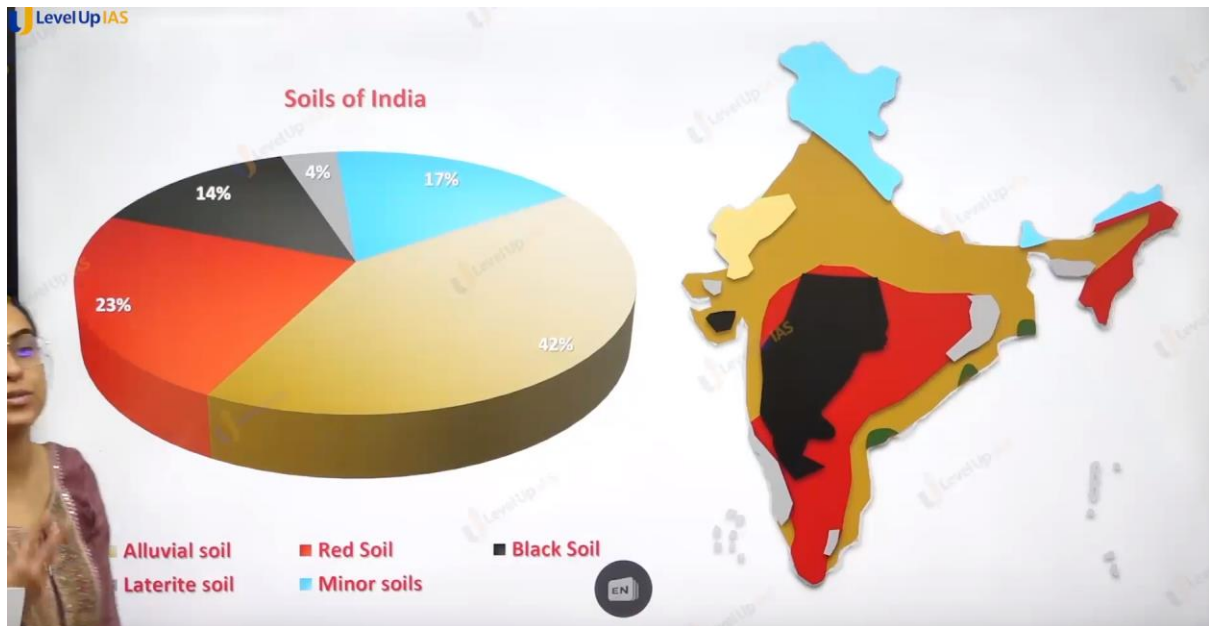
Bedrock



Role of Time

1. Time determines whether the soil has developed many horizons or not. Time determines the maturity of soil.
2. Mature soil has fully developed horizons. Ex. Equatorial soil. Whereas young soil does not have fully developed horizons.





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Alluvial Soil

- Transported soil
- Deposited by the river
- Rich in Potash
- Poor in Phosphorus
- Found in River basin, Valleys and delta
- Supports all types of crops.
- Over cultivation, sand mining

Himalayas

Alluvial region

Teesta

delta region

Most common in Peninsular region

From weathering of Gneissic rock

Poor in nitrogen, phosphorus and humus

Dry soil with coarse texture (Fit for agriculture with fertilizers)

Supports dry crops – Oilseeds, Pulses, Tobacco, etc.

Found in Telangana, Karnataka, Bundelkhand, Deccan Plateau



Most common in Peninsular region

From weathering of Gneissic rock

Poor in nitrogen, phosphorus and humus

Dry soil with coarse texture (Fit for agriculture with fertilizers)

Supports dry crops – Oilseeds, Pulses, Millets, Tobacco, etc.

Found in Telangana, Karnataka, Bundelkhand, Deccan Plateau



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Black Soil

- Soil of deccan region
- From weathering of basalt rock
- Found in Maharashtra, Kathiawar, South MP, Telangana, Karnataka pt.
- Rich in Lime, Iron, Magnesia, Alumi



High water retention + Over irrigation → Water logging

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Minor Soil

Forest soil	Arid Soil	Peaty soil	Saline soil
Mountain Region	Rajasthan	Along the coast	Degraded soils (Over irrigation)
Parts of the Podsol	Poor in humus	Black and sticky	Found in poor drained and Dry region, also in water logged regions
Best for forestry	Kankar For	Water logged	Sundarban, Gujarat
	With irr fit for t	High peat content. Not for cultivation	

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Laterite Soil

In Highland with Hot and humid climate

Through the process of laterization → leaching

Red in colour

Fit for forestry and plantation crops.

Poor soil for agriculture.

Used mostly for brick making, Aluminum industry

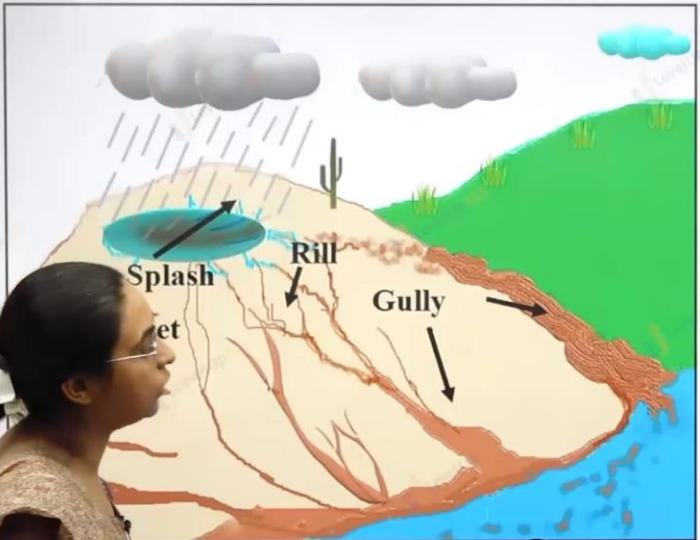
Formation of IRON PAN



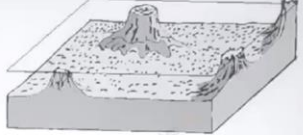


dryaneshwar.mogal.ias@gmail.com(8421928891)

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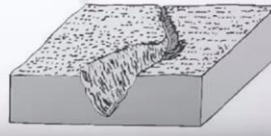
Splash
Rill
Gully



(a) Sheet erosion



(b) Rill erosion

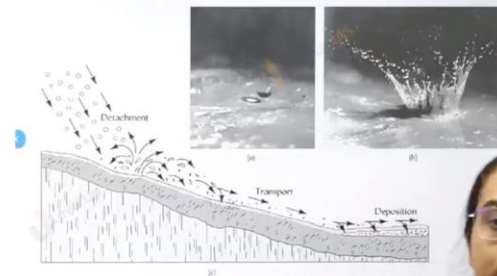


EN

SOIL PROBLEMS

1. Soil Erosion:

- Removal of fertile top layer. It is associated with mining, wrong agricultural practices like fallow land (bare land without any crop cover), deforestation, over grazing.
- Fallowing of land exposes soil to hitting of raindrop leading to splash erosion. Continuous erosion by raindrop leads to erosion of entire surface in form of sheet known as sheet erosion.
- Surface water flows that cause sheet erosion rarely travel more than a few metres before turning into rills and causing Rill Erosion
- Rill eventually widen to become gully erosion



1 (a) Raindrop falling on the surface (b) Splash impact of raindrop (c) Process of water erosion (modified from Sticher 2010) 12.2.1.3. Rill erosion (channel erosion)

SOIL PROBLEMS

2. Soil Degradation: It refers to decline in productivity and quality of soil. It can be due to:

- **Soil Pollution:** Excessive use of chemical fertilizers, pesticides etc Waste Dumping, Mining, Disposal of industrial effluents
- **Wrong Agricultural Practices** like monoculture, unscientific rotation of crops, salinisation due to cultivation of water intensive crops in dry regions, Shifting Cultivation.
- Capillary action leads to accumulation of calcium carbonate beneath (kankar), the soil will act as impermeable to water and water gets logged as happened in Indira Gandhi canal regions of Rajasthan.

SOIL PROBLEMS

3. Soil Desertification: Extreme form of soil degradation where soil is no longer fit for cultivation

• **Reasons:**

- Spread of desert like conditions along the productive soil.

Extreme form of Land degradation: Same points as degradation but with more intensity



Solutions

- **Soil organic matter** should be maintained as it provides fertility, better water retention and holds the soil together
- **Plant trees, shrubs** to provide wind protection and also binds soil to roots.
- **Mulching:** Covering on ground of hay, straw and crops residue which prevents soil from erosion and preserves moisture in soil. It also prevents growth of weeds
- **No-Till/Minimum Tillage Methods** to conserve the soil of moisture, reduce erosion and does not disturb the soil
- **Erosion-reducing grazing practises:** Rotational grazing is a method of moving livestock from one pasture paddock to the next. Each paddock is given a rest period and is allowed to regrow naturally, reducing soil compaction and erosion.
- **Terracing esp in hilly areas** to prevent ploughing against the slope.
- **Windbreaks (also known as shelterbelts)** are rows of trees and shrubs planted along the edges of agricultural fields to provide wind protection
- **Organic farming, Precision farming** to reduce the excessive use of fertilizers, pesticide
- **Growing climate suitable crops** to prevent degradation



2012

Consider the following agricultural practices :

1. Contour bunding
2. Relay cropping
3. Zero tillage

In the context of global climate change, which of the above helps/help in carbon sequestration/storage in the soil?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None of them



Ans c .

Questions

2020: The process of desertification does not have climatic boundaries. Justify with examples.

2020: Examine the status of forest resources of India and its resultant impact on climate change.

2019: Discuss the causes of the depletion of mangroves and explain their importance in maintaining coastal ecology.



